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CYAN MAGENTA YELLOW BLACK

Editor's Note

"Make new friends but keep the old; one is silver and the other gold."

A year and a half ago, I was sprawled on the floor of room 803, typing those words hurriedly into my computer. The pink alarm clock on my desk was pointing to ten; just two hours before the deadline for the Minjok Herald literary contest. After days of wavering back and forth on my decision to enter the contest or not, I had finally made up my mind to enter a small piece looking back upon a special friendship I was lucky enough to have had during my junior high school years. One hour and fifty-six minutes later, I had finished my first submission to the Minjok Herald entitled "And the Other, Gold."

Now, a year and a half later, I find myself sitting at my desk in room 606, not in the seat of a contest applicant but that of the editor-in-chief. This seat comes with countless responsibilities and sacrifices, but most of all, this seat presents great opportunities. Opportunities to revolutionize, to influence, to develop: all these and much more are thrust upon the lucky person who is given the chance to take a seat in this chair. Thrilled as I was to be this lucky person, I would be lying if I did not admit that it intimidated me. All the decisions that had to be made, all the events that needed to be planned, and most of all the sheer weight of the fact that I would be responsible for even the tiniest errors- in fact, I am still trepid about all of these things.

But I am not alone. I have my fellow editors, all of whom are as new to their jobs as I am to mine. The newly recruited 16th wavers, some who make their debut in this issue- also new. Together we have created our first Minjok Herald, an issue that does make a new voice but keeps the old; one is silver and the other gold. Old things are not necessarily bad; traditions were followed in regards to the contents of the paper and the division of departments. The feature section installed last year will be continued this year, but the Foreign Language specials will be replaced by the Arts section that will focus on one prominent area of the arts and its place within KMLA. Though not so apparent in this issue, changes regarding the overall design of the paper were made and will continue to be made- for the better, of course.

One down, three to go- just as I made my journey from the timid contest hopeful to the still timid but now somewhat confident editor in chief, Minjok Herald will evolve through next May. How it evolves and what it evolves into is entirely dependent upon us. Us, not as in the Minjok Herald members, but 'us' as in all members of the KMLA community and beyond. Minjok Herald has always strived to be and will always strive to be the true voice of KMLA: a voice with a purpose, a voice that reflects our community, and a voice that will be heard. Watch, hear, and take part in making our voice Minjok Herald grow stronger, more confident, and more colorful (and perhaps with better Editor's Notes). We look forward to the next year with you.

Staff of Minjok Herald
Editor-in-Chief Kim Ye-Rin

P 3. Through the Words
P 4. Around our School
Looking Back on the First Semester
Student Council Elections
P 6. People
Welcome to KMLA
Worldwide KMLA
P 10. Feature
Uniform Satisfaction Survey
A Message from Foreign Teachers
Rudia the Hanbok Tailors
Wear When
Looking Inside Dormitory Laundry
Where Hanbok Should Stand
P 22. Arts: Music
Music Is…?
Music in KMLA
Returning to the Basics of Music
Finding Yourself and Losing Your Shoes
P 27. Voices
Old Road, New Road
Creative Activity Concentration Period
Too Much to Sacrifice
School Jackets Mandated?
The Secret
Midterms and Finals
Back to the Old
P 35. College Column
Rivalry Between the Best
P 36. Crew

http://www.trulylovable.com/media/513-the-very-best-of-friendship.jpg

THROUGH THE WORDS

QUOTES

Perhaps‘ friendly rivalry’ would be a perfect way to sum up their relationship. (pg. 35)

And to the 12th student council of KMLA: prove to us that we made the right choice. (pg. 5)

KMLA without *hanbok* is banana milk without banana scent.(pg. 12)

Samulnori became a part of my identity. (pg. 25)

In order to make much out of the Creative Activity Concentration period instead of it being a mere experience, all you need a little bit of consideration and a sense of balance. (pg. 28)

If India has the Untouchables, Korea has the beggars in the subways. (pg. 31)

page 3
THE *MANITTO* EVENT

page 4
THE 12TH STUDENT COUNCIL

The *Manitto* Event

Opportunity for New Friendships

"Being a girl in the International Field, I had little opportunity to interact with the boys in the Minjok Field. Through the *Manitto* Event, I talked with some of those boys for the first time and came to know them better."

Many KMLAians probably shared sentiments similar to 16th waver Ho In-Hee's. The *Manitto* Event, held from September 28th until the day of the Minjok Festival, gave people the unique chance to be secret friends of others.

Some cheered, while others were frustrated as the students drew lots with their '*Manittees*' on it. Typical ways of look after their *Manittees* was sending texts or letters with heartwarming messages and giving small presents like snacks. Sometimes, some unusually enthusiastic students gave larger gifts. The event was concluded at the Minjok Festival, where twenty minutes were allotted for finding one's *Manittee* and revealing one's secret identity.

After the whole event was over, the students' opinions about it differed from person to person. There were some things in common—a little bit of disappointment was one of them. Many of the students, who expected both thrill and enough support from someone, were frustrated. In most of the cases, their *Manitto* did not take care of them as they expected, and they felt disappointed.

But this is not to say that there were no positive reactions to the event. Many students said that they could get to know more people through this event. As Ho In-Hee mentioned already, the Manito event was a great opportunity for those students who do not have chances to know each other in their usual school life.

Additionally, communicating with someone without knowing who he or she is helped many students do away with stereotypes about the person. "I didn't know him well before the event," said Kang Ji-Young, "and judged him based on some stories I've heard about. However, by communicating directly with him, I realized that I misjudged him." In KMLA, rumors tend to be created and spread very easily. So judging someone without actually knowing or meeting him or her is also very easy. Many of these fixed ideas, derived from rumors about some people, could be amended after the Manito event.

Starting a day with an encouraging text from an unknown supporter was a pleasant experience for everyone. Becoming acquainted with someone new was also a great experience. Despite a bit of frustration, the *Manitto* Event was still a small breaking away from the daily routine.

Choi Ye-Rin
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

The 12th Student Council

Many students were busy during the second week of September. Some were decorating posters, some were typing answers into their laptops, some were preparing speeches, and some were cutting up ballots. As a new semester was getting into gear at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, the students were preparing for the 12th student council election. KMLA boasts a student autonomy system where students can make their voices heard through the elected student representatives of the executive, legislative, and judicial branches. The new members of the 12th student council were elected to represent the KMLA family on September 8th.

The key feature in this semester's council election was the many candidates for the chiefs of the councils and the sole candidates for the members of the council. Seven students ran for the chief of the executive and legislative branch, while three students ran for the chief of the judicial branch. This was a large number of candidates compared to the past elections. However, the candidates running for the members of the legislative council and the executive council were all sole candidates, with the exception of the male member of the executive council in which there were three candidates. All in all, a total of 21 candidates put much effort into their election campaigns from September 4th to the 7th, and on September 8th, the rest of the students made their way to the auditorium to make their choices. In the afternoon of September 8th, the ballots were opened and counted, and the results were ready to be announced. After their induction into office during the September 19th assembly, the new members have officially assumed their duties as student representatives.

Now it is their turn to step up to the plate and keep the ambitious promises they made during their campaigns. The student council is the essence of the school autonomy system, and now we, the KMLA family, have chosen the 12th student council. Students must give encouragement and constructive criticism to the members of the student council to work with diligence and passion and create a fruitful second semester of 2011. And to the 12th student council of KMLA: prove to us that we made the right choice.

12th Executive Council	
Chief – Shin Joo-Hyung	1. Stabilization of EOP Promoter Policy 2. Stabilization of Minjok Currency Policy 3. Invigoration of Department Meetings 4. Strengthening of Council Interrelations 5. Reform on Student Council Election Procedures
Vice Chief – Sung Kyung-Sik	
Vice Chief – Han Jae-Youn	
Manager – Lee Do-Hyun	

12th Legislative Council	
Chief - Shim Keon-Woo	1. Reverse Proposal Board 2. Open and Public Representatives' Assemblies 3. Special Task-Force 4. Real-Name Proposal System 5. Student Council Briefing 6. Student Council Manifesto
Vice Chief –Yoon Seong-Heon	
Vice Chief – Koh Ji-Yeon	

12th Judicial Council	
Chief – Jang Da-Ye	1. Hand-Written Testimony for Final Defending Speeches 2. Verification of Additional Information in Reading Final Defending Speeches 3. Patrol Promotion 4. Utilization of Essential Information Board 5. Ban on Presence of Defendant at Student Participation Court 6. Computerization of Merit and Penalty Points 7. Posting of Jury & Final Decisions Offline 8. Direct Control of Court Patrol by Judicial Council 9. Minimization of Judicial Interference in Student Participation Court 10. Retrial & Court of Appeals
Vice Chief – Cho Na-An	
Vice Chief - Park Kyung- Tae	

Lee Eun-Ji
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Welcome to KMLA!

Meet the new faces of the 16th Wave

A: Sung Ji-Yoon B: Jung Yoo-Jin C: Han Jong-Hyun D: Kim Sang-Hyun

Q1. What was the motivation to come to KMLA?

A: I liked mostly everything about KMLA. The dormitory life especially fascinated me.

B: like many people know, I lived in San Francisco since I was three years old, and I came back to Korea because of my father's job. Mom did not want the family to be separated, so all my family came to Korea. Obviously, I had to go to school, so I researched about the schools in Korea. It seemed to me that KMLA provided opportunities that I wanted, such as preparing for colleges in United States. Also, I believed that KMLA could give me the experience of Korean heritage that I could not have until now.

C: To tell the truth, I first applied for the entrance examination last October. Unfortunately, I failed. However, having regrets, I tried again, and this time, I was accepted.

D: To give a typical answer, I came to KMLA to find my cultural heritage. To give a more truthful answer, the facilities in the last school were horrible and I wanted to transfer out of the school.

Q2. How was the school different from what you thought before you came to KMLA?

A: I find myself to be busier than I thought I would be before I came into KMLA. Personally, I hope that self-study period could be longer.

B: Well, the first thing is the English Only Policy. Before I came here, I assumed that I would be using English all the time. I believed I would have no difficulties in communicating. However, I realized that Korean was used much more than I expected. There are more differences as well, but the EOP or the lack thereof was the biggest shock to me.

C: Outside of the school, there were many rumors that the facilities in KMLA are old and insufficient. However, the rumors are false and I'm more than satisfied with the facilities in both the dormitory and the classrooms.

D: Before coming, I was afraid that I'd be bullied because I'm a transfer student. Those worries were meaningless. All students and teachers were kind and friendly. However, I was surprised that students receive penalty points for eating foods other than breakfast, lunch, and dinner. I can't understand this because students in our age must eat a lot to grow up and banning the students to eat causes many students to be hungry.

Q3. How do you think of our school uniform?

A: It is more comfortable than I thought. It is a real advantage that we can freely wear anything beneath the uniforms, though there are exceptions. The uniforms keep us warm during the cold weather.

B: I got my first impression of Korean uniforms from "Kkotboda Namja." However, after I researched about KMLA, I found out that no one was wearing the uniform I saw in the drama. I think KMLA's uniform is very unique, and it definitely fits with the school's name,

which is "Korean Minjok" Leadership Academy.
C: Well… When I first saw it, I thought it would be very uncomfortable. However, it was quite comfy when I wore it. Still, the formal dress is very uncomfortable. The color is agreeable, but I think the makers didn't consider much about the design.
D: The formal dress is just horrifying. Other than that, the uniforms are agreeable even though the design is a bit… um… unsatisfactory

Q4. Where did you live before? What school did you attend to before?

A: I came from Anyang, and I went to Anyang High School.
B: In San Francisco, I think the main difference between Korea and San Francisco is diversity in culture, race, and so on. You get to experience different and various cultures in San Francisco. Conversely, in Korea, you get to feel some sort of unity, which certainly differs from the diversity that I experienced in San Francisco.
C: I lived in Jong-no, Seoul. I went to the same middle school as Song Ho-Young, a 16th waver.
D: I attended National University of Singapore High School of Mathematics and Science in Singapore. It was a fun school. ^^

Q5. What are you interests and the clubs you are participating in?

A: I am playing violin in KMLA Orchestra. I am also participating in WITHUS. I love to write, so I want to be a part of the Korean school newspaper as well.
B: Right now, I am in Game Over, which is a basketball club, and SOS. I consider myself to like a great deal of things, not limited to a few. I am also interested in *Minjok Herald*.
C: I'm interested in math and singing. I also have a great will to teach. So, I applied for NAB, the school's singing club and was accepted. In addition I applied to Sigma, school's math teaching community service club. Unfortunately, they didn't have any openings, so I couldn't join.
D: I'm very interested in basketball and music. So, I applied for Crossover and KMLA Orchestra. Fortunately, I was able to join both clubs.

Q6. What to you grow up to be? What subject do you plan to major in college?

A: I want to be a judge, and I want to major in business administration.
B: After graduating from KMLA, I hope to go to England and study international law.
C: My dream is to be a prosecutor. However, I'm planning to major economics or business administration.
D: I haven't chosen yet. I'm planning to look over many majors during my high school life.

Q7. Why did you choose international (domestic) field?

A: I believe that going abroad will enable me to have a variety of experiences.
B: I think a lot of people choose to be domestic field because international course has some difficulties in language. However, for me, that's just the opposite. It will be very hard for me when I choose to go to the domestic field.
C: I chose the domestic field because I plan to work in Korea when I grow up. I thought it would be better to graduate college in Korea. I understand that competition is tough in the domestic field. However, I came to KMLA to experience things that I wouldn't be able to in ordinary schools. I don't regret my choice.
D: Um… I choose international field because I lived in Singapore for a long time… I haven't decided for sure yet. I may change to domestic field later on.

Q8. After a month at school, what were your most impressive class and teacher?

A: I enjoy American Politics class a lot. We debate and discuss a lot and I feel free in class. I believe it is the most "KMLAstic" class among my classes. Mr. Ryu, the chemistry teacher, is my favorite teacher, for he is funny and respectable.
B: Mr. Hinde's class was very interesting for me at first. To be honest, I was a little bit frustrated. Math is not my type at all, and I had to listen to Mr. Hinde's classes without understanding the basic concepts of math. But as I listened to his classes more and more, they became enjoyable. Mr. Hinde made math interesting for me. It is difficult to choose a particular teacher as my favorite because I believe that every teacher in KMLA is unique in their own way.
C: I'm not sure yet. To me, every class is interesting and fun.
D: Haha. To tell the truth, I sleep in most of my classes ^^; All except the PE class. So, the most impressive class was PE class. I like Jung Sun-Hee teacher the most because she's so kind to me and helped me a lot as an advisor.

Q9. Any last words?

A: Thank you for being friendly to me when I first came here. I wish to be closer to all the students in KMLA.
B: As you all know, my Korean skills are lacking, so my KMLA life could be difficult, but I am very joyful that I am in KMLA right now.
C: I hope to make a great experience here in KMLA. But I do have some complaints. Why are there so many words in Frequency? And give me some time to sleep~! OTL
D: Well, I look forward to all the fun experiences I'll have in KMLA. Also, I want to do well in the mid-terms and graduate - with a 5.0 GPA. ^^

Yoo Jun-Seung, Hwang Ye-Seul
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

International Public Policy Forum (IPPF)

While most KMLAians were busying themselves with preparations for their mid-term exams in Hoengseong, a team of four fourteenth wavers were going through a very special experience halfway around the world in New York. Lee Jae-Hyun, Song Young-Re, Jeon Young-Jae, and Lee Seung-Ho participated in the Bickel & Brewer International Public Policy Forum (IPPF) with Mr. Wayne Baumgardner as the coach on April 9th. More than 340 schools from 37 countries participated in this grand tournament. This year, the KMLA team proudly triumphed in all the preliminary rounds, and kept up their winning streak until the semifinal round where they lost by a small margin.

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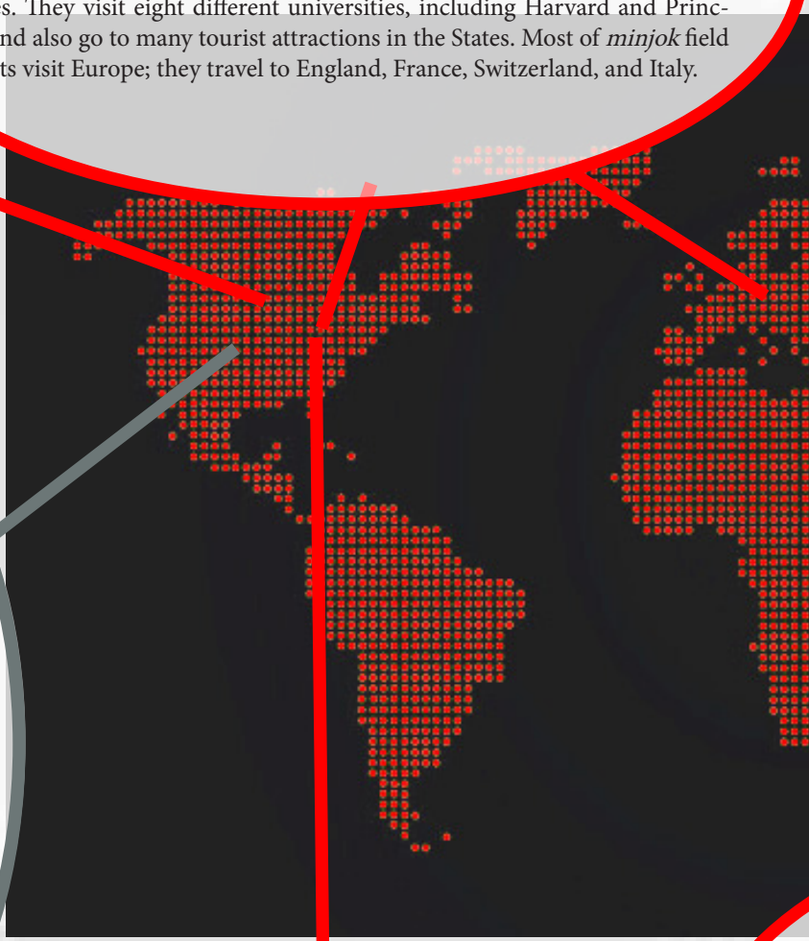
Vision Trip to US and Europe

Every year, 11th graders of KMLA choose to travel either United States or Europe – vision trip. The primary goal of vision trip is to give KMLA students a chance to broaden their views and experience more of the world. For the International Field students, the vision trip is also an opportunity to visit US colleges. They visit eight different universities, including Harvard and Princeton, and also go to many tourist attractions in the States. Most of *minjok* field students visit Europe; they travel to England, France, Switzerland, and Italy.



World Leadership Congress of Hugh O'Brian Youth Leadership Program (HOBY)

Some KMLA students have participated in a camp called Hugh O'Brian Youth Leadership Program (HOBY) in recent years. The goal of this camp is to provide the participants with a leadership program that includes many various activities and leadership eudcation. Also, prominent figures of Korean society are invited to give lectures to them. After the program, 25 students are selected to participate in the World Leadership Congress (WLC) from HOBY Korea. This year, six KMLA students, Kim Ji-Yeon, Ryoo Da-Yeon, Yang Jin-Hyuk, Ghim Taek-Min, Kim Seung-Min, and Kim Hyun-Jee, qualified to attend the international leadership program.

International Olympiad in Linguistics (IOL)

In KMLA, students have qualified for the national team of the International Olympiad in Linguistics (IOL) for years. The Linguistics Olympiad measures students' ability to understand the principles and application of various linguistic theories. Participants who have gone through each country's team selection process represent their nation at the international competition. This year, fourteenth waver Park Hyun and sixteenth waver Kim Hong-Soon qualified in the Korean Olympiad in Linguistics (KOL) and represented team Korea in the IOL at Carnegie Mellon University, Pennsylvania, USA, from July 24th to 30th.

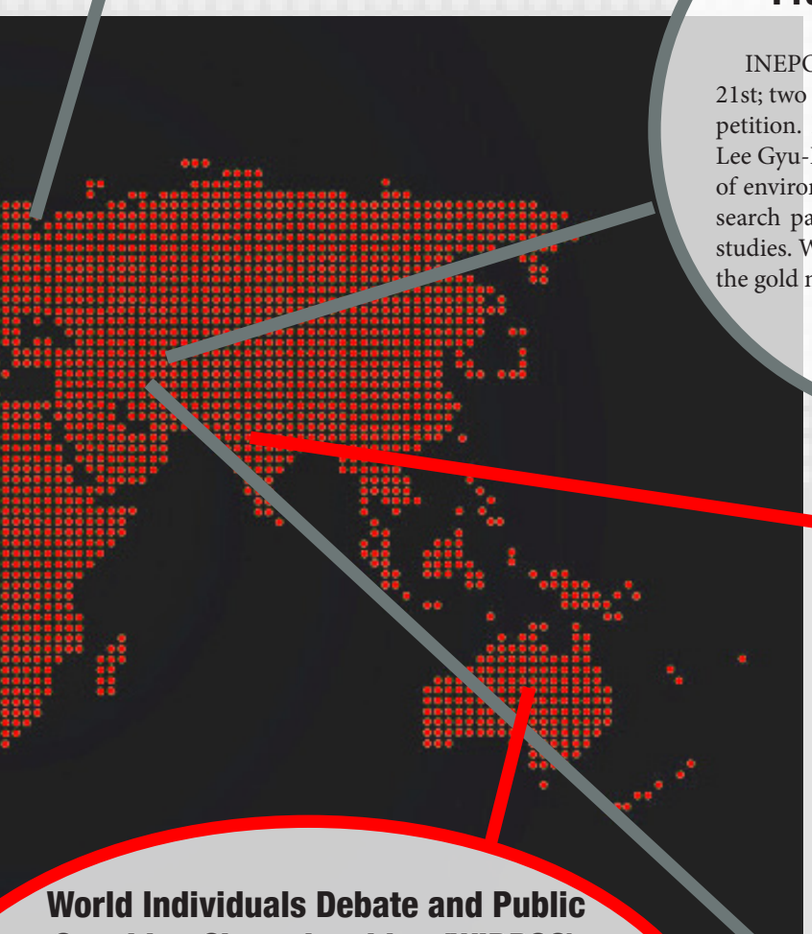
Worldwide KMLA

chools Debating Championships (WSDC)

ol debaters, the greatest prestige is to be a member of the national Schools Debating Championships. In each country, team mem- rough national competitions and a rigorous team-pool training fourteenth waver Kim Kun-Ho proudly qualified to participate in he tournament lasted from August 16th to 26th in Scotland.

International Environmental Project Olympiad (INEPO)

INEPO was held in Turkey from May 18th to 21st; two KMLA students competed in the competition. Fourteenth wavers Kang Hee-Gu and Lee Gyu-Bin conducted experiments in the field of environmental science and submitted the research papers they had written based on their studies. When they flew back to Korea, they had the gold medal around their necks.



Overseas Volunteering : Habitat and FFT

KMLA's student volunteer clubs, Habitat and For & From Them (FFT), go on volunteering trips abroad every year. Habitat's volunteering is mainly focused on providing homes for those who cannot afford them. This year, Habitat is going to Thailand, to give the poor new shelters to live in. On the other hand, FFT focuses on educating the poor kids in India. FFT members are traveling to India to teach children various subjects including arts, physical education, and music.

World Individuals Debate and Public Speaking Championships (WIDPSC)

Vhile WSDC is the grand-slam-tournament for debate teams, World vidual Debate and Public Speaking Championships (WIDPSC) is a rnament for individual public speakers. In the competition, partici- ts compete individually in four events: prepared speech, impromp- peech, dramatic interpretation, and debate. Two KMLA students, enth wavers Kim Ye-Rin and Cho Na-An were selected in national lifying rounds and competed in the international tournament from il 1st to April 8th, in Brisbane, Australia.

International Young Physicists' Tournament (IYPT)

International Young Physicists' Tournament is one of the most prestigious international physics competitions for high school students. Teams from more than twenty nations participate in this tournament. After sixteen physics problems were released last year, the team members conducted experiments, completed researches and prepared for the coming competition that will be held in Tehran, Iran. With outstanding results in a nationwide qualifying competition, four fourteenth wavers—Bae Gwang-Bin, Jang Hee-Jae, Kim Kun-Ho, and Lee Sang-Jae—were selected to represent Korea from July 22nd to 31st.

Lee Eun-Do
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Feature:

Clothes

In

KMLA

What are you wearing right now? The heavy winter overcoats on top of the colorful everyday hanbok uniforms? Or perhaps you're rebelling against the mandatory school jackets by simply donning a more comfortable jacket of your own. Whatever the case is, and whatever you are wearing, the fact of the matter is that clothes matter. In this feature, *Minjok Herald* dives into the behind-the-scenes processes of our school uniforms, explores the implications of having *hanboks* as school uniforms in the 21st century, and brings to you in-depth interviews conducted with people directly involved with keeping our traditional costume alive. Enjoy!

Uniform Satisfaction Survey in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy

Minjok Herald conducted a survey on 197 students in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy to find out what the students think about their school uniforms.

>

Although there were some complaints about wearing *hanbok*s as school uniforms, 155 out of 197 KMLAians supported having Korean traditional clothes as our uniform. One student even wrote, "KMLA without *hanbok* is banana milk without banana scent." Moreover, 105 students were satisfied with the school uniform because of its style, quality and comfort of the clothes. However, no one voted for their serviceability as their reason for satisfaction.

> *"KMLA without hanbok is banana milk without banana scent."*

There were, although a minority, students who cast doubts on *hanbok*s being our school uniform. They voted style as the major reason for their dissatisfaction, and pointed out the discomfort arousing from *hanbok*s such as the incessant possibility of tripping on the long skirts and *durumagi*.

Students strongly preferred the everyday summer uniform over the other four; it was rated as the most favorable and the most consumable one of all. The difference between the votes for the most popular and the least favorable uniform was significant: 84 students favored summer *saenghwal hanbok*, while only one student voted for summer ceremonial dress as their favorite. On average, each student possesses 3.37 informal summer uniforms. This is probably because of the available variety in colors and the hot weather in summer. Due to the lack of diversity in types and relatively short period of spring and fall in Gangwon province, spring and fall attire was least consumed.

an average student possesses informal summer uniforms **3.37**

84 students favored summer saenghwal hanbok

Students also gave some constructive comments about our uniforms through the survey. 181 students expressed the need for price reduction. Many students also insisted on upgrading the summer uniform so that it could be better ventilated. Others asked for reforming summer *durumagi* into half-sleeve, and designing overcoat to wear during the seasonal changes.

KMLAians were generally satisfied with and proud of our school uniform; however, constant improvement in quality, price, service, and color was called for.

Jeon So-Yeon
Feature writer, 16th wave

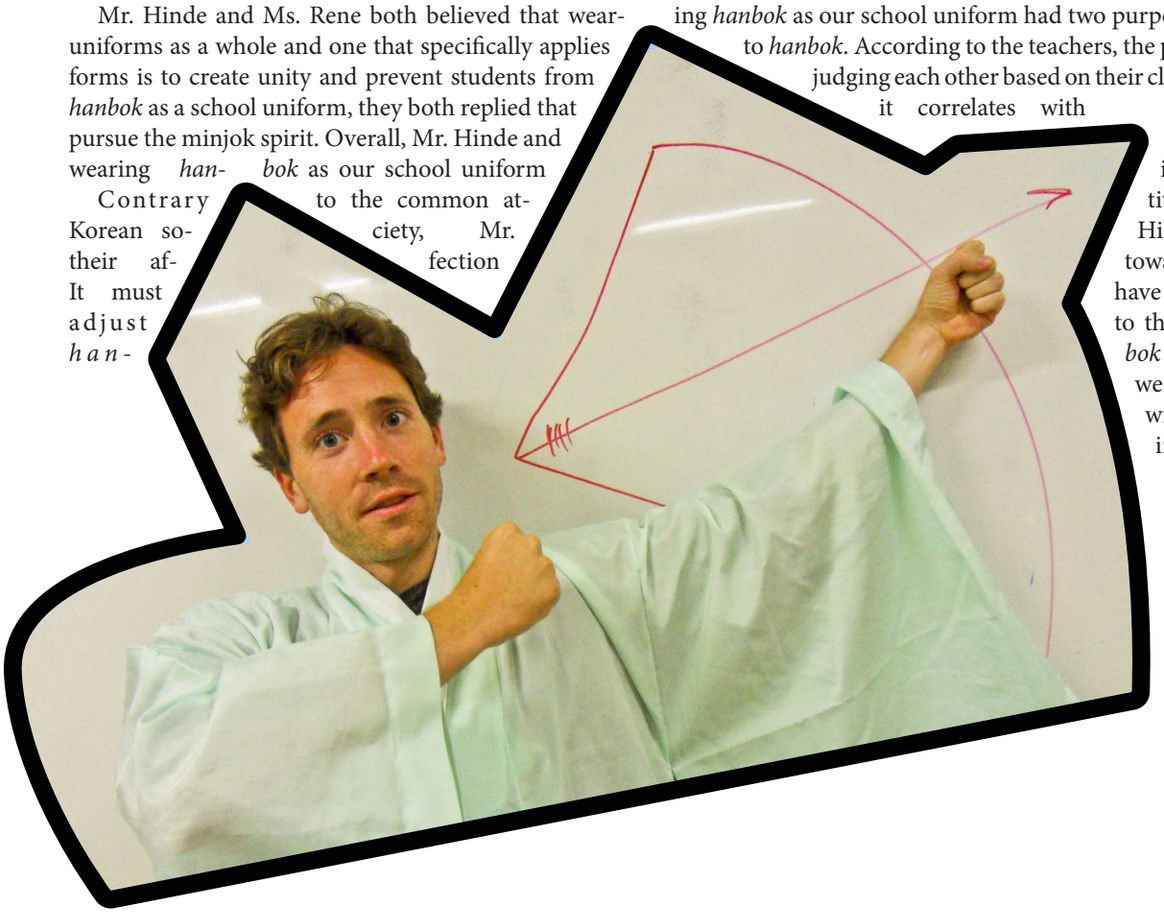
A Message from Foreign Teachers

It is a normal sight to see students of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy wearing *hanbok* on a daily basis. Not only do they wear *hanbok* going to and from school, but they also feel hesitant to take them off indoors. However, it is unfortunate that the same thing is not happening beyond the boundaries of KMLA. Koreans nowadays tend to think of *hanbok* as traditional clothing that is only worn on holidays and used for cultural events. They fail to grasp the true beauty of *hanbok*, which the foreign teachers of KMLA have well done.

Foreign teachers, even those who came to Korea recently, have already seen the positive side of wearing *hanbok* as our school uniform. Mr. Hinde, who has stayed in Korea for two years and has spent one semester here at KMLA, held a positive view towards *hanbok*. Before coming to KMLA, he had seen countless kinds of school uniforms. He was not used to seeing students in school uniforms, and those uniforms did nothing to change his feelings of unfamiliarity to feelings of awe. However, Mr. Hinde stated that *hanbok* is more stylish than any other typical school uniforms. "I especially like the school uniform here in the springtime because there are so many different colors," he said. Ms. Rene also pointed out that she loved the diversity in colors of our school uniforms. In addition to this, she said that she thought the uniforms made the students look well-behaved. *Hanbok* not only reminded the students to bow to the elders, but also made them use nice words in their speech. Perhaps due to this good behavior and colorful *hanbok*, Ms. Rene sometimes thinks that she is living back in time.

The majority of the students here apparently like wearing *hanbok*, and the teachers also thought that the students are satisfied. Neither of the two has heard any serious complaints regarding the school uniforms. However, Mr. Hinde said that students did not seem to like wearing the formal *hanbok* that students are required to wear to morning assemblies. In addition to this, Ms. Rene suggested that the school uniforms be made a bit warmer so that the students can feel comfier in the winter. Both teachers like wearing *hanbok* themselves as well. Mr. Hinde thinks *hanbok* is very stylish and comfortable, and Ms. Rene likes how it doesn't make her think about what to wear for that day.

Mr. Hinde and Ms. Rene both believed that wearing *hanbok* as our school uniform had two purposes: one that applies to school uniforms as a whole and one that specifically applies to *hanbok*. According to the teachers, the purpose of wearing school uniforms is to create unity and prevent students from judging each other based on their clothing. As to why KMLA wears *hanbok* as a school uniform, they both replied that it correlates with our school beliefs and helps pursue the minjok spirit. Overall, Mr. Hinde and Ms. Rene both thought that wearing *hanbok* as our school uniform is very effective.



Contrary to the common attitude toward *hanbok* in the Korean society, Mr. Hinde and Ms. Rene showed their affection towards this traditional garment. It must have been hard enough for them to adjust to the new environment and wear *hanbok* all the time. However, they went above and beyond what we wished of them; they liked wearing *hanbok* and respected the clothing as part of our culture. Koreans should appreciate our own clothing as much as these two foreign teachers do. Since big changes are the end results of small changes, a change in the society can start right here and now, in KMLA.

Suh, Yeon-Soo
Feature Crew, 16th wave

Rudia – the Hanbok Tailors

Interview with Ms. Shin Hyo-Chul, the Madame of Rudia Traditional Dress Gallery

On a typical Monday morning, a typical student of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy will set out from the dorm in a graceful but sweltering formal hanbok dress to attend the morning assembly. After four hours of class – with considerable sweat gathered in the back – he is freed from this burden. After eating a grand – hopefully – lunch, he will leave wearing a lighter, thin summer uniform. Under the warm sun and with a full stomach, he will sleep soundly for the rest of the school hours.

Life in hanbok is one of our school's unique features, and we all know the name of the designer too well: Rudia. However, apart from that name, there is not much we know about Rudia. Minjok Herald visited Rudia Traditional Dress Gallery to interview Ms. Shin Hyo-Chul, the madame of the shop and the designer of all our hanboks.

Minjok Herald: Nice to meet you, Ms. Shin, can you tell us briefly about Rudia Traditional Dress Gallery?

Shin Hyo-Chul: Well, our shop is actually only a small gallery in Seoul. For 25 years we made ceremonial dresses only – for weddings and stuff. KMLA uniform is an exception that we started making after Mr. Choi Myeong-Jae's request.

MH: How did Rudia gallery start its relation with KMLA?

Shin: Our relation drew from the very beginning of KMLA – the first wavers donned our dresses. Mr. Choi first saw our gallery after a lecture in Seoul National University of Science. He was so impressed by our hanboks that he requested the design of KMLA uniform to us. The twelfth and the thirteenth wavers are the only students who did not wear our clothes; they wore uniforms made by SMART Student Wear Company. However, due to opinions that hanboks, though they may be uniforms, should be made by expert hanbok designers, the school asked us again to design the uniforms. From fourteenth wavers and on, students of KMLA are wearing our hanboks again.

MH: How were the designs of our uniforms created and developed?

Shin: KMLA uniform was first designed by Mr. Choi – he told us how he wanted the uniform in the form of a modernized hanbok. The designs were altered slightly from wave to wave until now.

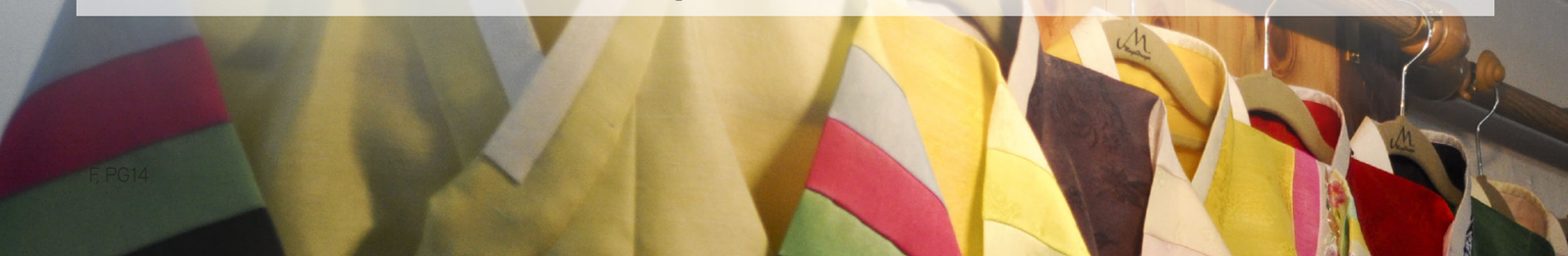
As we made the uniform, we considered students' convenience as first priority – which I am glad to hear it is being fulfilled thoroughly. The belt and ankle straps were substituted with rubber bands for this purpose – though it damages the whole style. The fabric was our greatest concern, since our clothes had to survive three years with an adventurous high school student. Since we could not use silk – the clothes had to be washable – we used a type of synthetic fiber which was strong and soft to the touch. The spring and summer uniforms were produced according to similar principles – though using different fabric, of course.

The colors of the uniforms were chosen with greatest care, because we know that the students want bright-colored uniforms; no one actually loves green-and-brown uniform. However, the school puts restrictions on colors, along with shorter tops and slimmer pants, so we can only try our best within the limits.

MH: Are all the school uniforms, from winter coats to formal hanboks, designed in Rudia?

Shin: Yes, of course – from the winter coats to the hanbok dresses. The school requested many other products to wear with the uniform, since wearing padded jumpers with hanbok is, at least to me and the school, unacceptable. So the winter coats were created with the help of a parent who worked in such industry. The school held a hearing of parents, students, and teachers to choose the design. Before the thirteenth wave, the winter coats were optional, which caused it to become nearly extinct. Only after it became mandatory did the students of KMLA love the coat: its merit is in effectiveness, not in elegance.

The formal hanboks – from the scarves to the ankle straps – were designed after the full traditional formal hanboks. Freshmen each year have difficulties wearing them properly; so I have to go myself all the way to KMLA to teach them how to wear the traditional dresses. For the convenience of sixteenth wavers, we omitted ankle straps from the formal hanboks.



MH: The students had a few inquiries to make - why are the buttons so easily torn away?

Shin: Well, I guess the primary reason is the students' wildness. We attach the buttons all by hand using 8 loops of string, but the problem is the button being just too heavy. It is comparatively large and made of bronze – it was designed by Mr. Choi himself. The substance could not be changed because it just doesn't feel the same when it's made of plastic. Please note that strings in every color and needles are prepared in Mr. Seong's office. He once told me that the students are just too afraid to come into his office, but all students should note that he would never punish someone for trying to fix a button.

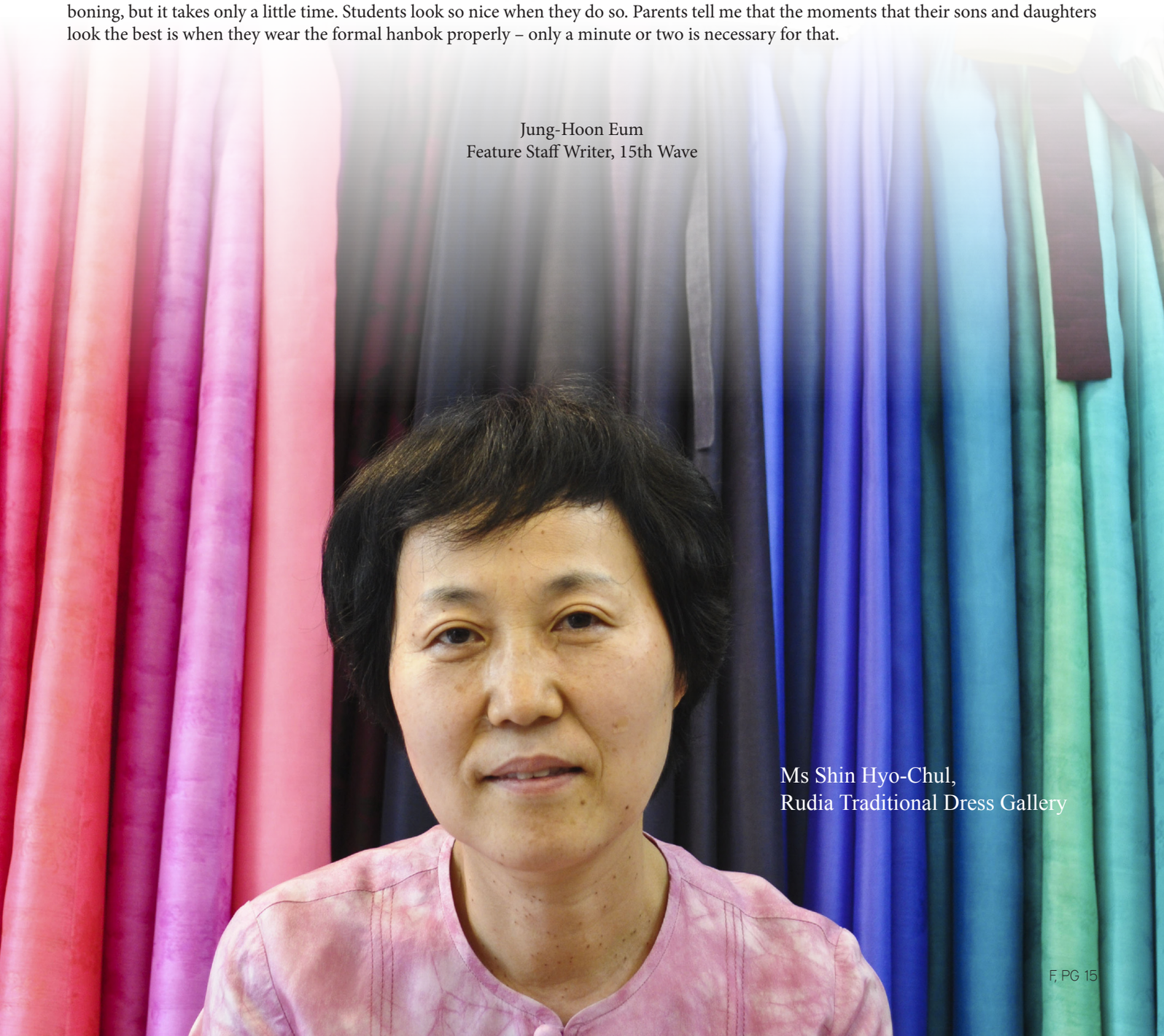
MH: What do you think of modernized hanboks compared to traditional ones?

Shin: Well, frankly, I cannot say I approve the modernized one. I love our traditional dresses, and before making KMLA uniforms, I only made traditional dresses. KMLA uniforms are an exception since they are worn by students, and frequently damaged.
Other Asian countries keep wearing their traditional dresses despite of the inconvenience – like Japan's Kimono and China's Qipao. Korea, on the other hand, dilutes that tradition too easily for fashion.
But, please, mind that I am not criticizing KMLA uniform. Students wearing and advertising hanbok has a great positive effect on keeping our tradition. Mr. Choi, the chairman, is a great patriot of this country; he loves hanbok as much as he loves the country. Though it is inevitable that the hanboks be modified a little to fit the students, the experience of getting used to hanbok is precious in itself.

MH: Do you have anything else to tell the KMLA students?

Shin: Though it is nothing much, please wear your dresses properly. The morning frenzy might leave no time for all the buttoning and ribboning, but it takes only a little time. Students look so nice when they do so. Parents tell me that the moments that their sons and daughters look the best is when they wear the formal hanbok properly – only a minute or two is necessary for that.

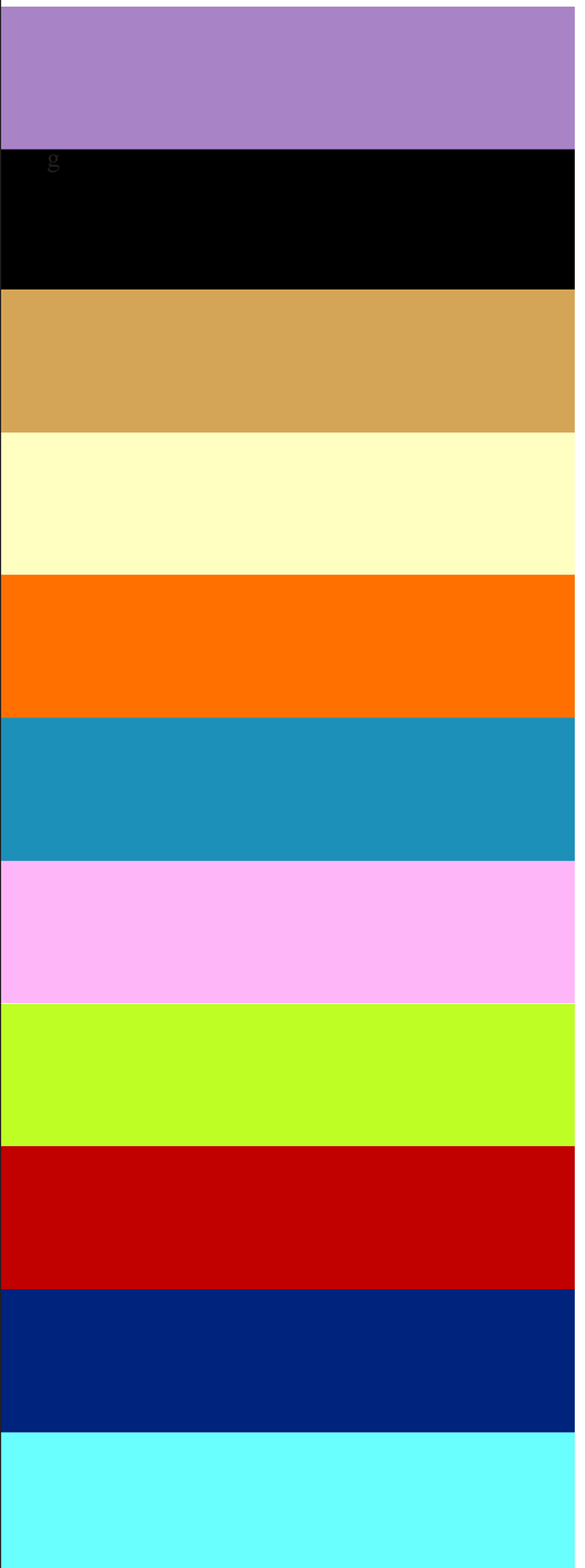
Jung-Hoon Eum
Feature Staff Writer, 15th Wave



Ms Shin Hyo-Chul,
Rudia Traditional Dress Gallery

Looking into the History of KMLA Uniforms

Timeline



Korean Minjok Leadership Academy retains a history of fifteen years- a history in which many aspects of the school gradually changed into what it is today. One of these aspects is school uniforms; thus, *Minjok Herald* gathered photographic data to convey how the students' uniform fashion has changed throughout KMLA's history.

KMLA's uniform can be divided into roughly two sets: one is *saenghwal-hanbok*, modernized clothing that students commonly wear in their everyday activities; the other is *yeabok*, traditional attire worn on special occasions. The selection of colors of the modernized *hanbok* uniform changed throughout history, ranging from a combination of red and black to white and pink, green and black, and so on.

Looking into the colors of the *yeabok*, we can see that the color of today's formal winter-wear *hanbok jeogori* for female students is yellow-green. Going back into KMLA's history, however, color for the same cloth was bright yellow. Then, other deviations, such as red and pink appeared as colors of the *jeogori*. The skirt did not change much; it has always remained a dark color: navy blue. For the boys, the winter-wear formal *hanbok* did not show any prominent transfigurations, always remaining the same tone of color - dark vest, and grayish sleeves and pants.

The summer-wear traditional *hanbok* also went through a couple of variations. For the most part, it kept a blue hue; however, exceptionally in 2003 girls wore pink outerwear and white *jeogori* with a pink skirt. Also, in 2005, students wore silvery white outerwear, and girls had white *jeogoris* with lavender blue skirts, while boys dressed all white from head to toe. But overall, the summer-wear formal *hanbok* had a blue sheen, differing just slightly in the tone of the color from wave to wave.

The school logo imprinted on the left chest of the students was another significant change. Right now, the school logo is a circle containing the national flower, *mugunghwa*, and a candle circumscribed by the school name printed in both English and Korean. However, until the 5th wave, the logo was only the pink national flower without the circle.

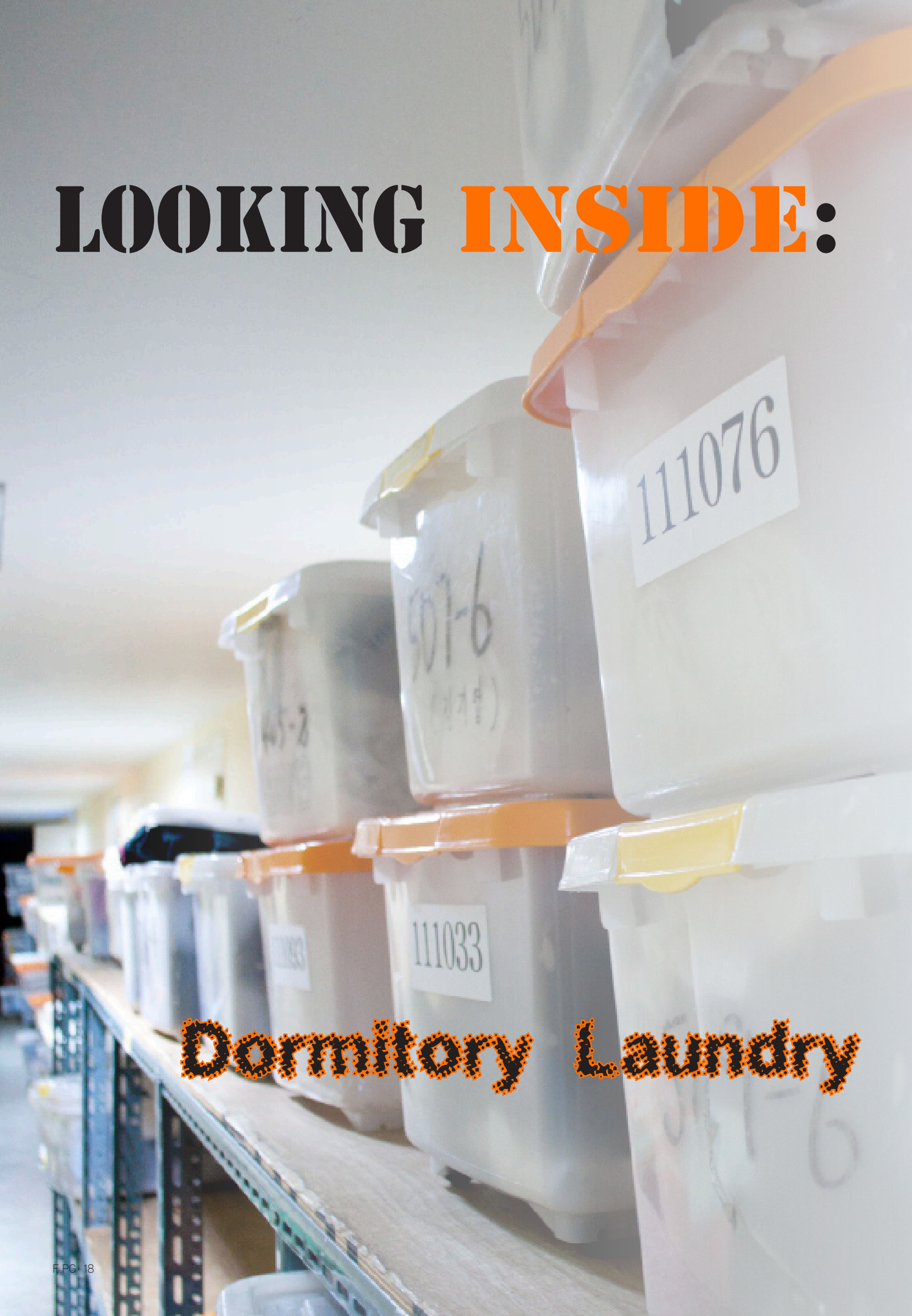
Nametags are currently embedded directly onto our uniforms. Until the 13th wave, nametags were attached to the uniforms by pins, not sewn in. However, due to the fact that a large proportion of the students did not attach the clip-on nametags, from the 14th wave, uniforms came out with nametags sewn in.

Furthermore, from the 1st wave to the 7th wave, students had to wear traditional hats as well as the *hanbok*. Both male and female students were required to wear *jeongjagwan*, and in formal occasions boys were required to wear *gat*. However, in 2003 October, the new principal, Dr. Lee, was appointed, and he questioned the effectiveness of having Korean traditional attire as an official school uniform when the world is rapidly becoming globalized. Thus, a survey was conducted; however, the result made clear that the students wanted the traditional *hanbok* attire. Therefore, the *hanbok* uniform prevailed and only the traditional hats were deemed unnecessary.

Likewise, the school uniform of hanboks has a history of its own. Throughout its history of 15 years, the *hanbok* uniform evolved, firmly took its place, and remains as a symbol of KMLA attire.

Lee Eun-Ji
Feature Writer, 16th Waver

LOOKING INSIDE:



Dormitory Laundry

7:55 in the morning, students pack up their laundries and place them in the basement on the 9th floor. The time clicks to 8:03. Dormitory laundry staffs arrange the laundries. After arranging the laundries, the staffs put them into washing machines and dry them; the workers finally complete all the laundries at 4:50 in the afternoon. Until today, we were indifferent to these hardworking workers who have managed our laundries as effectively as possible. *Minjok Herald* interviewed the workers, Bae Hyun-Du and Shim Soon-Ae, to figure out how they think about the work, school, and students.

Minjok Herald: Good morning. You have been working in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy for several years. How did you come to work in the dormitory laundry?

Bae Hyun-Du: I had been working in the laundry few years ago. One day, I saw a magazine advertisement looking for a person to manage laundry at KMLA. I signed up for the registration right away, and became one of the members of the dormitory laundry. I am satisfied with my decision until today.

Shim Soon-Ae: I was a typical housewife, before I started working in the dormitory laundry. One day, my friend introduced me a job at KMLA. It has already been nine years since I first put a student's laundry into the washing machine.

MH: Could you explain on how the students' laundries are managed?

Bae: We do the laundries from Monday to Saturday, mostly in the mornings. On Monday, Wednesday, and Friday, we do the male students' laundries first, since the amount of laundries is immense. On Tuesday, Thursday, and Saturday, we mostly do the female students' laundries.

Shim: The process of doing the laundries is very simple: First, put students' laundries into the washing machine; one student's laundry per machine. Put in the detergents, such as *Pigeon* and *Supertie*. Then, the machine automatically does the washing and drying. Since there are only two of us working as the dorm laundry staff, Bae Hyun-Du manages the washing process, and I manage the drying process. Although washing is done by machines, we check whether the laundries are properly washed and dried. We also check whether the laundries could be done in one day; if not, the left ones would be the first to go into the washing machine the next day. We try not to delay the laundries more than two days, except for special occasions.
Bae: Students should not forget that dry-cleaning is unavailable in the dormitory. Only washing laundries in water is what we can do for the students.

MH: What do you think about your work here in KMLA? Are there any hardships you face working in the dormitory laundry?

Bae, Shim: Well, we are doing our best to manage the laundries, and we are satisfied with our work here. However, we also acknowledge that students can complain about the dormitory laundries. Such complaints are mostly due to laundries not being dried or washed properly. For us, it is most frustrating when ink or chocolate in the pockets of a laundry taints other clothes during the washing process or the drying process. We cannot handle with the taints easily, and we feel sorry for the student who will receive their laundries messed up. We also have difficulty in unfolding the laundries, such as socks or t-shirts; the laundries are not done properly when they are done being folded. We sometimes get irritated when the laundry containers are not filled up, since it slows down the laundry process. So, we do not deal with the laundry containers filled less than half of it.

MH: It must be hard to satisfy all the students. In cases of conflicts with students, how do you manage them?

Bae, Shim: Of course there are students who criticize dormitory laundry. Students usually complain when the laundries are not done properly or tainted severely. It is hard for us to confront the students, since we work in the dormitory laundry when the students are at their classes. So we leave memos in the laundry containers to persuade and explain to the student the reasons why the laundry was not done properly. We also posted our phone-numbers on the bulletin board to call us if the laundries have problems or if the laundries were not done for more than three days in a row.

MH: One last question: are there any comments you would like to give to KMLA students?

Bae, Shim: We would like to urge to students not to put anything in the pockets of the laundries, such as cell phone, pen, chocolate, and gum. After the laundry is done, we sometimes find electronic devices malfunctioning, impossible for us to fix. Pen, chocolate, and gum taint the other clothes during the laundry. We cannot check every laundry since the time is limited. Also, when the laundries are not dried, please understand the circumstances since it is hard for us to check all the laundries whether they are dried properly. If you have any questions on laundry process, please call Bae Hyun-Du and Shim Soon-Ae.

MH: Thank you for participating in this interview and managing our laundries for several years. We appreciate your help.

Bae, Shim: Thank you.

Park Sun Woo
Staff Writer, 15th Waver

Where HANBOK Should Stand

A renowned *hanbok* designer was treated as a *dangerous* customer to enter *Hotel Silla* by the employee. Not because she was a mischievous guest or a terrorist holding a grenade, but because she was wearing hanbok in a bustling buffet. Hanbok's voluminous and long skirt was too *dangerous* for it could cause trouble while serving. The waiter was publicly criticized for his inordinate treatment toward the customer, but mostly for his disdain toward Korean traditional garment. This incident showed the true picture of *hanbok* in Korea.

Hanbok is no longer a finery costume that represents Korea; rather it is cumbersome and outdated clothes. Until 1980s, *hanbok* was easily spotted in streets on Korean traditional holidays like *Chuseok* or Chinese New Year's Day. On the day of holy wedding, *hanbok* was the main garment to be chosen. But the abrupt inflow of Western culture along with its fast fashion weakened the position of *hanbok* in the clothing industry. Here, an interview with Park Sool-Nyeo *hanbok* designer, who has exerted herself for the last 27 years for *hanbok*, gives a fresh enlightenment and reflection of our society.

Minjok Herald: Could you briefly introduce what your job is and what you do?

Park Sool-Nyeo: I make traditional hanbok, but I also make modernized version of hanbok for outdoor activities, because the number of consumers for the traditional ones is decreasing. Not only making *hanbok*, but also introducing the beauty and value of the clothes through fashion show is what I do. Hanbok fashion show is very effective in catching the attention of many teenagers or people in twenties or thirties. Since the models are usually celebrities, it is a great chance for *hanbok* to catch the media and peoples' attention; thus, naturally arousing attention for the garments presented.

MH: Is there any special reason for you designing *hanbok* instead of popularized clothes?

Park: When I was young, I particularly loved the texture of silk. Also, the vividness of *hanbok* was very tempting. I always envisioned myself of making beautiful *hanbok* out of colorfully flowing silk. Also, my mother influenced me a lot when I actually chose to become a *hanbok* designer. She used to always say, "As long as Korea exists, there will be people who look for *hanbok*. Don't chase money but chase the spirit and cultural heritage that *hanbok* contains." This was the main reason I chose to design *hanbok*. Not for the money or popularity, but for love of our tradition and clothes.

MH: Is there any philosophy you try to contain when you are making *hanbok*?

Park: I try to revive our country's tradition, but I also try to make them more comfortable without changing them too much. I work with my students, who I have been teaching for past 20 years, so that I can get some help to make perfect clothes. The usual work speed is one *hanbok* per day. Because *hanbok* is not something that could be churned out from a machine, human effort and manual work are the keys to making a perfect one piece. That is what I value the most about *hanbok*: care and heart of the one who made it.

MH: When do you feel proud of yourself? Also, when do you face difficulties?

Park: I feel thankful and proud when not only Koreans, but also foreign celebrities (for example, Britney Spears, George Winston, and Mika) exclaim that *hanbok* is beautiful. However, it is unfortunate that many people think of them as clothing for temporary events. When my devotion of popularizing *hanbok* seems to fail, I sometimes feel frustration and skepticism of the works I have been doing for more than two decades. But I want people to remember that *hanbok* is scientific clothing: you do not need to overstrain yourself, but relax and leave it up to the elegant and beautiful piece of clothing to get its shape. I go to many meetings wearing *hanbok*, and this is nothing to be embarrassed of or afraid of.

MH: As a *hanbok* designer, what is your opinion on "*Silla Hotel* incidence"?

Park: *Hanbok* designer, Lee Hye-Soon, was caught for violating dress code in *Silla Hotel*. It was embarrassing and pitiful event that revealed the hypocrisy of the hotel: Advertisements and slogans all suggest that "Silla" Hotel embodies the tradition and cultural heritage of Korea, but it is just a show to please the customers. Even Korean foods are being neglected in the hotel where a traditional *kimchi* is hardly found. When a high class hotel belittles *hanbok* and Korean conventions, it takes very little time for the citizens to think in the same way. So, I think that leaders of the country should pave a way for *hanbok* by wearing it in official occasions. Rather than this scandal becoming a temporary issue, I hope that the Korean citizens recognize where *hanbok* stands and change their attitudes. Simply condemning the hotel is foolish because the citizens themselves would be one of the hotel guests that complained about the dress code of allowing *hanbok* to the hotel.

MH: As globalization accelerates, *hanbok*'s values have been degraded. What kind of measures could be done?

Park: I think the declination in its importance is due to the inconvenience. However, it is not only *hanbok* that is uncomfortable. If we change our thoughts about *hanbok*, we will be able to wear it in our everyday lives instead of Western clothes. The public media and famous intellectuals will have to wear *hanbok* often. *Hanbok* industry is now in recession and Koreans should open their wallets to purchase one, so that the industry can revive. Based on the financial firepower, infrastructures for larger manufacture and globalization of *hanbok* would be arranged.

MH: Korean Minjok Leadership Academy wears *hanbok* as a uniform. What do you think of this?

Park: It is good that the uniform is designed with respect to the original *hanbok*, so students and teachers would be able to think of our traditional attire at all times. However, the design of *saenghwal hanbok* differs greatly from the traditional one. I am worried that people might think of the modernized version as the original one. But I heard that, fortunately, the school wears the original one on special occasions. For *hanbok*, making is half the process and wearing is another half. So, learning the steps of properly wearing *hanbok* should be emphasized in your school, too.

MH: Do you have any last word to remind KMLA family?

Park: Regardless of your status after graduation – I hope you all will succeed in your own fields – never forget where you are from, especially when you are studying abroad. Remember the origin and identity that defines you different from Americans, French, or any other countries. Keep your original resolution when you entered KMLA, full of ambition to become the global leader for our race. Lastly, wear *hanbok* occasionally and introduce it to foreigners. I'm pretty sure they all will love the gentle waves and lofty elegance of *hanbok*.

Designer Park walked a long and solitary path as a *hanbok* designer. Her genuine passion and love formed who she is today. She started as a new face who knocked on the door of famous figures. But, now, it is the celebrities that knock on the door of the designer's building.

Public recognition is the driving fuel that would procreate more and more *hanbok* designers. More demand triggers more supplies. The citizens, people who fed their children and themselves in the land of Korean peninsula should play their role to sustain their ancestor's conventions and customs. That is why *hanbok* is still valuable and that is why the designer Park continues to wear *hanbok* to a formal appearance when everyone would prefer to wear Vera Wang or Versace.

Wearing *hanbok* as a uniform has been the most pivotal tradition of KMLA. This tradition should not be wavered because *hanbok* is perceived in the society to be obsolete. KMLAians all have the duty to keep this tradition that arouses respect of the uniform as a remark that represents not only our school, but also our nation.

Kim Hyun-Jee
Feature Writer, 16th Wave

ARTS: MUSIC

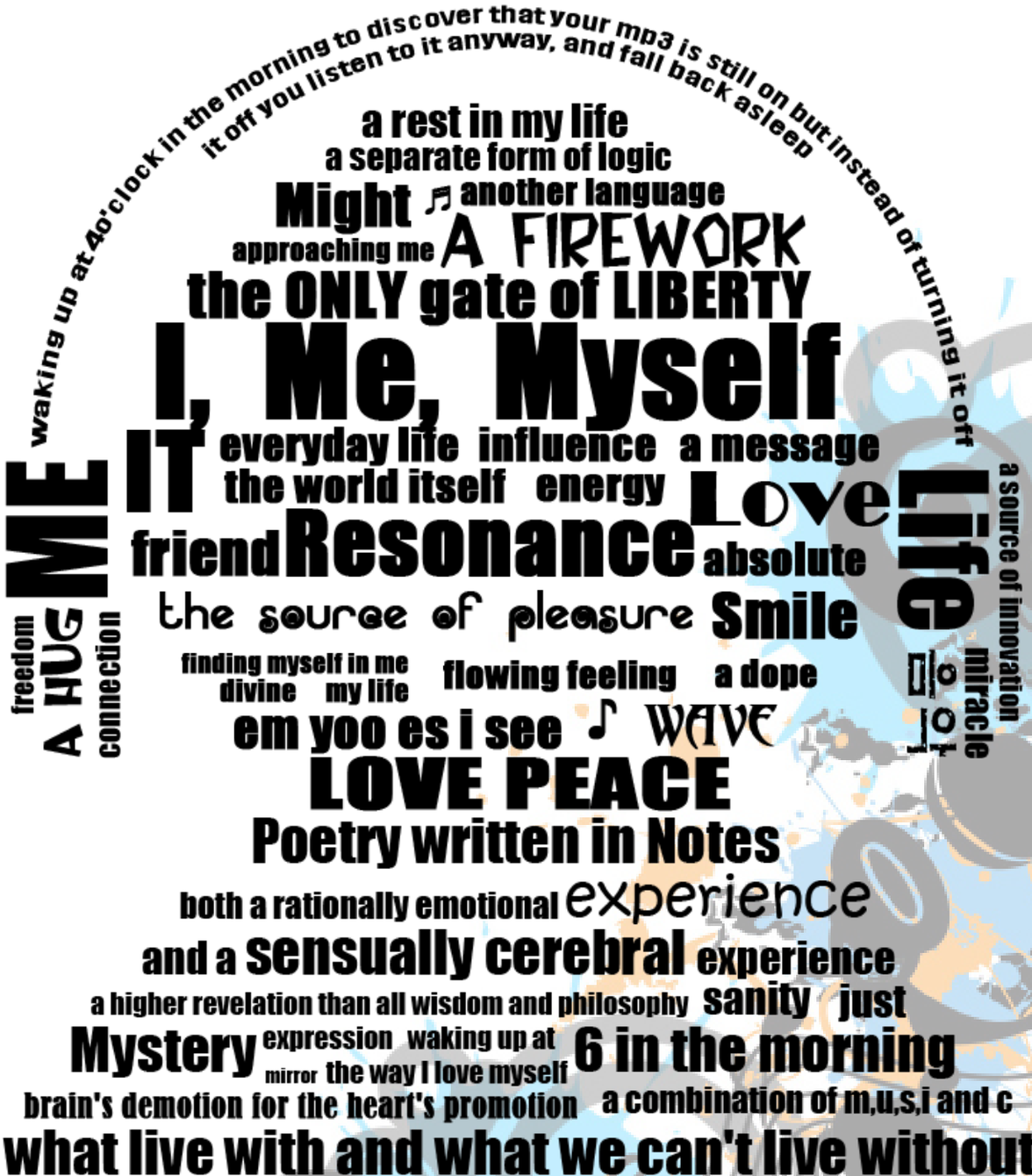
MUSIC AROUND KMLA

page 22
SAMUCHIMAND KOREAN TRADITIONAL MUSIC

page 25
RETURNING TO THE BASICS OF MUSIC

Music Is...?

Q: What does music mean to you? To KMLAians, music is…



Samuchim and Korean Traditional Music

The entrance ceremony of the 16th wavers nears the end. On the stage are seniors dressed in red, blue, yellow, and white and black. The gong strikes one low and deep vibration through the crowd. For the next few minutes, there is nothing else but the excited beating of the freshmen's feet and the glowing faces of the performers.

Samuchim, which gained tremendous popularity after this spectacular performance, is a Korean traditional music club. All twenty members of this club have their own areas of specialties among the four instruments: *kkwaenggwari, jing, jang-gu,* and *Book*.

Nowadays, they are busy selecting the new members from the sixteenth wave applicants. Due to some changes in school club activity policy, *Samuchim* has set an orientation period called the training to educate the applicants. During this session, each fifteenth waver member takes charge of the sixteenth wave applicants. Of course, it is not an easy task for both seniors and newcomers to undergo this hard educating period.

Despite the overriding hardships and hectic schedule, no sign of displeasure can be seen from any of the members. Sixteenth wave applicant Kwon Young-Jin said, "It is fun to learn *Samulnori*. It is a tough challenge for me, and I still make many mistakes; however, I'm doing my best to learn *jang-gu*. I believe playing Korean traditional music is not a common experience I can get," she added. "I really want to thank the seniors who gave me this opportunity." The club leader Kim Do-Yeong,who manages the entire group of members and applicants, said that "Although there are difficulties in fostering the harmony of sounds among about twenty participants, the process itself is worthwhile of devoting my time and energy."

Lee Hye-Jun
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Orchestra and Classical Music

A Spanish playwright Miguel de Cervantes, widely known for his work Don Quixote,once said, "Alas! All music jars when the soul's out of tune." Placid and magnificent music is exactly what is needed for KMLA students. Two school orchestras, KMLA Orchestra and Minjok Orchestra, readily provide them with the opportunities to taste the charms of classics.

KMLA Orchestra, recognized for its proficiency, grandeur, and brilliance,is a pure Western classic orchestra led by fifteenth waver Park Sun-Woo. They perform in various musical concerts of both in and out of school, such as Minjok Love Concert.To many of its members, KMLA Orchestra is a priceless stage where they can pursue their musical interests. Sixteenth waver Yoo Jin-sun who plays the contrabass expressed his passion for it by saying, "KMLA orchestra is one of the few things in this school that I can pour my mind completely into."

Minjok Orchestra, which prides itself on being one of the most fascinating clubs in KMLA, is well known as a fusion music orchestra. They perform music that seems like an exceptional challenge; fusing Western classics and Korean music together. Minjok Orchestra, led by fifteenth waver conductor *Hur Soo-Hyung*, consists of conventional orchestra instruments, but also keeps a rich assortment of Korean traditional instruments like the small-notched bamboo vertical flute, large transverse bamboo flute, and Korean fiddle. Lately, Minjok Orchestra is undergoing an ambitious plan such as merging of synthesizer into orchestra, or the joint performance with Seongnam Youth Symphony Orchestra. Apparently, KMLA students will now be able to enjoy more enriched music with the synthesizer from the second floor during the lethargic morning assembly.

Lee Hye-Jun
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Nagasu

The usual clamors from the television in the cafeteria- squabbles from obvious morning dramas and exacting broadcasts of the TV announcers- are far from what one would feel 'sweet'. However, there is one special occasion in which the sweet music attracts the attention of the whole student body. That is a TV program called 'I am a Singer', broadcast every Sunday by MBC.

'I am a Singer', commonly called '*Nagasu*', is a highly competitive music reality show where a competent group of renowned singers perform and get evaluated by the audience assessment panel. The one with the lowest rank drops. This extraordinary TV show seems to have become the means of recreation and enjoyment for many students.

Fortunately for the students, '*Nagasu*' is broadcast on every Sunday evening, ideal because it lapses with the dinner time on campus. Students take more meals than they usually do, and then, they run in search for the ideal spot to watch it. They slowly eat the food they have brought, waiting for '*Nagasu*' to start. When it finally does, the excitement begins. After an oppressive silence during the competition, the crowd bursts into a cascade of clapping and cheering at the end of each singer's performance. They enjoy and sympathize with the musicians' performances, discuss who the best performer of that day is, and most often, sing along the sweet lyrics and melody. When the program comes to an end, the mass of students, impressed, leave the cafeteria in swarms.

The shouts of joy and laughter the Korean Minjok Leadership Academy students make together: this short moment of weekly entertainment is perhaps one reason we can enjoy campus life.

Lee Hye-Jun
Junior Writer, 16th Wave

Rock and Hip Hop in KMLA

One of the widespread misunderstandings about Korean Minjok Leadership Academy students is that they are insensible about everything except studying. It would rather be true to say that KMLA students are quite insensible about everything except enjoying themselves. Among the myriad of the unique cultures of KMLA, music is a common form ofentertainment and leisure. Rock and hip-hop are two fields of music that many KMLAians are most exceptionally enthusiastic about.

There are several rock and hip-hop clubs in KMLA. Rhyme Factory, commonly known as RF, is a club that gained tremendous popularity by performing various hip-hop songs, lyrics, dances, and disc jockeys. PLZ and FITM are the rockers of KMLA who play exciting rock music on the stage during school festivals. This year, after their successful performances for the sixteenth wavers in the Freshmen Welcoming Party, the respective clubs have picked new members, who are currently preparing for their debuts.

However, PLZ, FITM, and RF are not the only chances for students to enjoy rock and hip-hop. Besides these clubs that have already gained general popularity, there are other clubs formed by those who love rock and hip-hop. Some unofficial performing clubs are a good example: clubs like Daeilband and XCL were formed by sixteenth wavers who want to pursue their passion for rock and hip-hop music. These unofficial clubs were freely organized by those who share similar musical interests and passion in common.

There is another type of club that was formed by music lovers: magazine clubs. KMLA Rock Magazine and Hip Hop Tribune respectively write and publish articles about rock and hip-hop. KMLA Rock Magazine primarily focuses on diverse rock genres, but also writes about other genres as well. Hip Hop Tribune mainly introduces good hip-hop songs and albums, and critiques them. These magazine clubs usually post their articles through an online forum and then collect and publish their articles in printed versions once or twice a year.

Lee Hye-Jun
Junior Writer, 16th Waver

Source: Mr. Sang-Joon Ahn

Returning to the Basics of Music

It all started when I began taking piano lessons at the age of five. This is too far back for me to remember, but my mom always said that the prospect of her experiment seemed brighter than she first expected. But for me, playing the piano wasn't all sunshine and roses. It wasn't long before practicing the *Czerny 40* over and over again became a tedious task. I gave up practicing, and would even run away from my lessons. To make things worse, my tutor constantly reprimanded me for not practicing hard. Enough was enough. Believing that I was old enough to make my own decisions, I told my mom that I wanted to quit. I remember her face showing clear disdain, but I managed to push through. Finally, I was liberated from the mind-forged manacles of those menacing black and white keys.

Though I broke up with the piano, I was far from waving fare-thee-well to music. When I began elementary school, I was fascinated with the recorder and decided to 'master' the instrument, only to end up awakening my parents late at night. In the States, I decided to play the clarinet, and found myself performing in a local student marching band. However, most of these endeavors were short-lived, and it wasn't until I met the *Janggu* that I felt like I'd found my destined match. Performing *Samulnori* with a group of students in my 5th grade class in the school festivals was enough to get me hooked; since then, I have practiced the *Janggu* with the enthusiasm I had lost for other instruments. This time, it seemed that I would never get tired of playing. But my performances often left me disappointed; I simply wasn't good enough. So I carried a small dream all the way up to Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, to accomplish what I hadn't been able to in my previous years.

It wasn't long before I became known as 'the guy who plays *Janggu* at *Hamyoung-dang* after dinner'; *Samulnori* became a part of my identity. Months have passed since I began leading the very club I had longed to be a part of, feeling like I could make all the changes that I wished for; all the hard work had finally paid off and the rest would be a piece of cake. But it simply wasn't so. At first, I thought it was merely a lack of motivation, not enough practice, and resented the world for not being cooperative. But it didn't take long for me to realize that I should not blame others. It was due to my own inaptness that I couldn't realize plans into action. I bred conflicts amongst us with a lack of communication. As I pushed myself to be more productive, I felt even more helpless, with no one there to provide me with directions. What I expected to be a dream-come-true felt like a nightmare. I almost mumbled the very words that came out of my mouth when I concluded my affairs with the piano, the recorder, clarinet…….But before the words could leave my tongue, I realized that I was neglecting something very important.

All these years I'd feared that my music would one day turn into stress. I parted with the piano and the clarinet because I was no longer enjoying the music I was playing. Now, I was being tormented as I sought to use music as a means to accomplish my own ambitions. So I decided to renew my mindset; to enjoy music simply for what it is, and nothing else. Returning to the very things that captivated me to *janggu*—from the crisp sound produced by the wooden stick to the complexity of the beats and rests and the elusive rhythm—these things rejuvenated the enthusiasm that was missing in my music for quite some time. With it things slowly came back to normal; music heals the soul, they say. Perhaps I'm yet to be productive, communicative, or trustworthy enough, but I'm certainly on my way, slowly but steadily adjusting to role of responsibility handed down to me.

But most importantly, I am happy now. And my amateurish instinct tells me that I am yet again in love with playing music.

Kim Do-Yeong
Guest Wrtier, 15th Wave

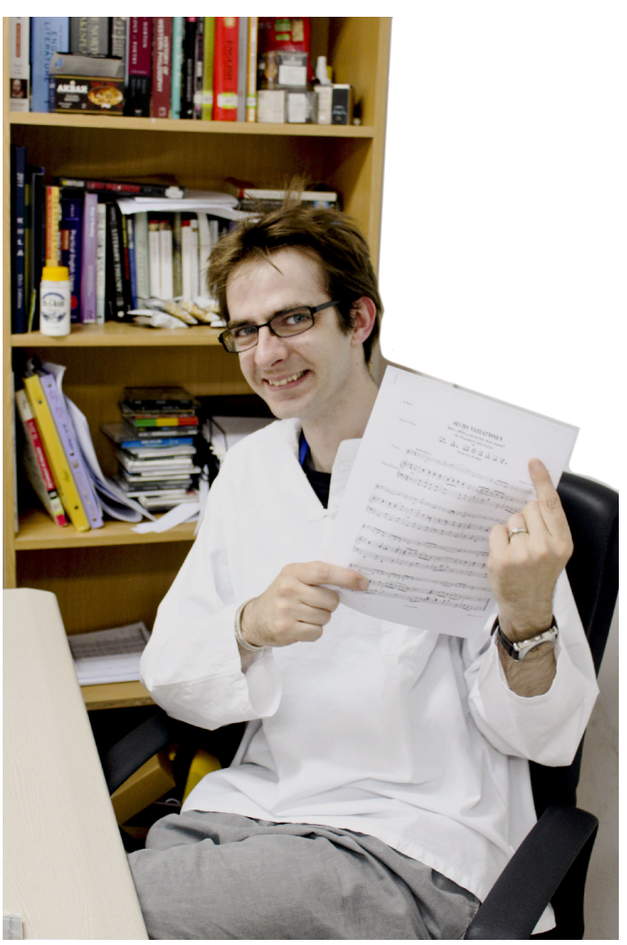
Finding Yourself and Losing Your Shoes

A Tragi-Comedy

Like a lot of people, I spent a good portion of my teenage years dreaming of rock 'n' roll stardom. Armed with a modest collection of Nirvana, Pearl Jam and Jimi Hendrix CDs, along with my cheap electric guitar and a self-belief bordering on absurdity (and a mirror much smaller than my ego), I was determined that one day, like Johnny B. Goode, my name would be in lights; that one day, venues like the London Astoria or Seattle's Crocodile Club would be like second homes to me; and that one day, my songs of love, hate and devotion would be the soundtrack to make or break a thousand hearts. I would have the tenderness of Jeff Buckley, the spirit of Patti Smith and the drawling spite of Bob Dylan. I would have a crowd of ten thousand in front of me at Wembley Stadium hanging on each word.

I lived in a small town. There wasn't really a great deal to do except either hang out at the local cricket green or think about leaving. Although my town was only about an hour or so drive away from London and the cosmopolitan vibes of Brighton, it was a world away from all the bright lights and fever those daring cities had to offer. My town was in a word, dull.

What my town did offer though, was a group of friends with dreams similar to mine. Several times a week we would all meet at one of our houses and spend the evening playing our crappy little songs, rehearsing them until the day came when we would finally come of age and be able to play at the local pub. This would ensure a local cult following that would eventually pave the way to international stardom. Our only audience at the time though, were the neighbours who, for some reason, never really developed an appreciation of our talents, despite having ample opportunity to do so. I'm sure that Mr. Jones in particular had extra reason for disliking us, seeming that his lounge backed on to my friend's garage. One day an ambulance pulled up outside his house and we thought we may have killed him by pushing his blood pressure up a little too far. Turns out however, that he had simply fallen off a chair whilst changing a lightbulb. Nevertheless, from that day on we found it prudent to be a little more considerate and turn our amps down from ten to nine.



This is how it went for a few years until we all graduated high school. Most of my friends got jobs and houses while I went to London in order to go to music school. Here I was, in London, the city of dingy, half-lit rock clubs, legendary venues, rock stars in the neighbourhood, and where surprisingly hot summers always sounded like reggae. If I couldn't make it here, I couldn't make it anywhere.

My routine remained much the same, except that high school became music school and my friend's garage became a number of small venues around North London. One thing that did change significantly was our audience. No longer were they the impassioned likes of Mr. Jones and their fury at sound. Instead, they were the indier-than-thou cynical scenesters happy to regail the innocents like me with their stories of having seen such and such a band before they were famous, or the slightly odd ageing punk rockers who would pogo to just about anything. My only real claim to fame at this point was to have been the original baasist for a band of hipsters who enjoyed a brief notoriety in Japan – after I had quit, of course. The bands bio on their Myspace said that I had quit in order to join the Israeli army.

But I didn't mind, because by then I had managed to fulfill another part of my dream. Those venues that I had dreamed about—those short years before had indeed become my regular haunts. Most of my evenings and weekends were spent in those cultural and musical Meccahs of Camden, Soho and Highbury and Islington seeing just about every band that came to town. And believe me, there were a lot – so many that I can't remember them all. I didn't need to be on the stage. All I needed was to be at the front of the crowd in the moshpit dancing like nothing else was important. One night that I do remember well was at the Brixton Academy watching Queens of the Stone Age supporting the Foo Fighters. I don't think I ever rocked so hard in my life. All night I was at the front totally lost in the ecstasy of pure rock heaven. Eventually the lights came up and I found that in all the chaos and mayhem I had lost both my shoes and my feet were soaked in sweat and beer and God knows what else. It was a dreary night in November and I had to get home.

I eventually made it to the nearest tube station having walked through the freezing, rain soaked streets without my shoes and the sodden socks I had long discarded; but I didn't mind. On the train I was attracting strange looks from all the commuters and revellers on their way home from a night on the town; but I felt fine. A group of guys came up to me in the train carriage – usually something to be wary of in that part of town at that time of night.

"Mate, where are your shoes?" one of them asked me.

"Oh, I lost them."

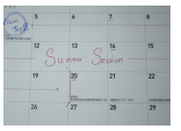
"You what?"

"Yeah," I said. "I was at the Foo Fighters show."

They looked me up and down until another of them said "Cool!"

I finally got what I came for – recognition, kudos and the knowledge that I had made an impression by rocking harder than anyone else that night and any other night I had dreamed of. I had made it.

Mr. Kelvin Tame
Guest Writer



page 29
TOO MUCH TO SACRIFICE

page 31
SCHOOL JACKETS MANDATED?

Old road, New road

About a month ago, the students of KMLA received a surprise of their lives. They could not stop themselves from slowing down and staring at what was going on, right on their way down from the dormitory to school: a huge construction field on the side of the road. For the next few days, the school was buzzing with excitement. Numerous rumors and news were spread about what was going on. Some claimed that a huge gazebo was going to take place there. Some claimed that there was going to be second road for people to prevent car accidents. Whatever the truth was, it was true that there were a lot of skepticism and doubts going on. Many openly criticized the school's irrational decision for the construction, claiming that there was no need for a construction and the waste of money. On the other hand, many believed that the school was simply taking care of an issue that had been bothering them for a while.

The truth, which is evident now, is that the construction was indeed for a second road, specifically for students. Although the school has not given an official statement as to why they felt the need for a human path, it is quite evident: for the safety of the students. Our school has two paths leading up to the dormitory. One is a side road full of foliage and birds – although it is abundant with nature, it is also narrow, therefore making it difficult for many students to use it at once. And, consequently, the risks of car accidents occur because of the second road. This is the one that the construction was stationed upon. Although this one is wide and made of concrete, it is also a path for cars, which makes it dangerous for passersby. Especially after class during lunch and dinner time, it is difficult for cars and the entire student population to take this road at the same time. This is exactly the reason for the construction.

Although the reason for the construction became clear after a while, the skepticism did not die easily. Rumors still flew and criticisms could be heard. The never ending discussion about the construction being a waste of money, how the new road takes more time than the old one, how the stairs that were built over the little cliff was as dangerous as getting hit by a car……. However, these criticisms are unnecessary and utterly useless. The fact is, what is done is done. The school acted upon careful decision and they would not have spent so much money on something like this if they did not have a good reason. And, they did. The school's priority is the students, that is, us. If there were no previous accidents, the school built this road to prevent future ones.

Out of curiosity, I tried a little experiment with a friend. I wanted to know if the new road was going to save time or waste it, as so many claimed. We tried two paths up to the dormitory, the old one and the new one, and for validation we tried this experiment on two different days at the same time. The result was undeniable. The old road took a minimum of five minutes while the new road took only two. We had never imagined such a difference in results and our attitude towards this new road became much more positive after that.

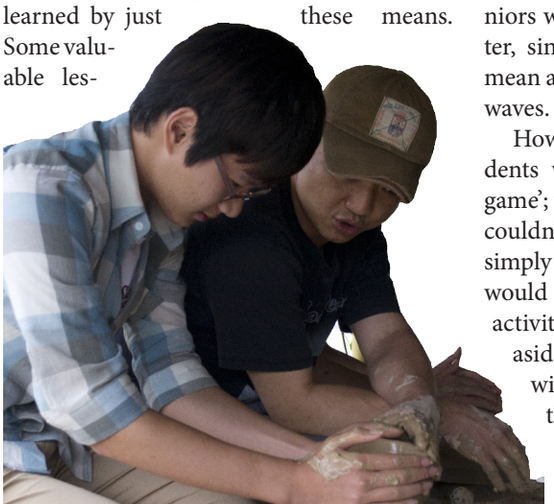
The fact is, not all of us like changes. Granted, some changes are not welcome or necessary. However, isn't that what KMLA is all about? Our school changes constantly and that is what make it KMLA. This road is simply one of those changes that we need to get used to. Some may still see it as waste of money, but what is done is done. The road is finished and we should make use of it for our benefit. It does not do us any harm, but actually gives us safety and three minutes to spare.

In an attempt to not sound too far-fetched, this road could even teach us a lesson. Changes are not altogether bad after time. Next time we are faced with changes that we do not exactly warm up to, try a different approach. Instead of criticizing and complaining, try adjusting yourself to the change. It is much less painful and has a less negative vibe to it. Remember, changes are not necessarily bad; it just takes some time getting used to. Give it a chance – that is what it deserves to the very least.

Han Ji-Hoon
Staff Editorialist, 15th Waver

Creative Activity Concentration Period

On May 18th 6:30 pm, all Korean Minjok Leadership Academy students were s itting in front of their desks. They weren't checking the dinner menu, studying for the Word Smart quiz, or finishing up their economics presentations. The students were holding on to their mouses tightly to quickly sign up for the Creative Activity Concentration Period. Each student had different programs planned in his or her mind for the exciting 3 days in the summer. Creative Activity Concentration Period provides KMLA students with the opportunity to experience things apart from the school curriculum. We do learn a lot from respected teachers in our school and various books, but there are some parts of life that cannot be learned by just these means. Some valuable lessons of life can only be gained through experiences. The Creative Activity Concentration Period will provide us with the opportunity to understand the world in a perspective unattainable in classrooms.



In KMLA no student is demanded to follow the curriculum set by the school; it is up to the students to decide which classes to take or not. Due to this factor, some teachers and students never have the chance to get to know each other. The programs are unrelated to the subjects, which means that students will be able to be acquainted with the teachers who teach classes that they are planning to never take. Also, spending much time together will help the students to get to know each other. Especially, seniors and juniors will get to understand each other better, since sharing the same memories will mean a lot to the students, regardless of their waves.

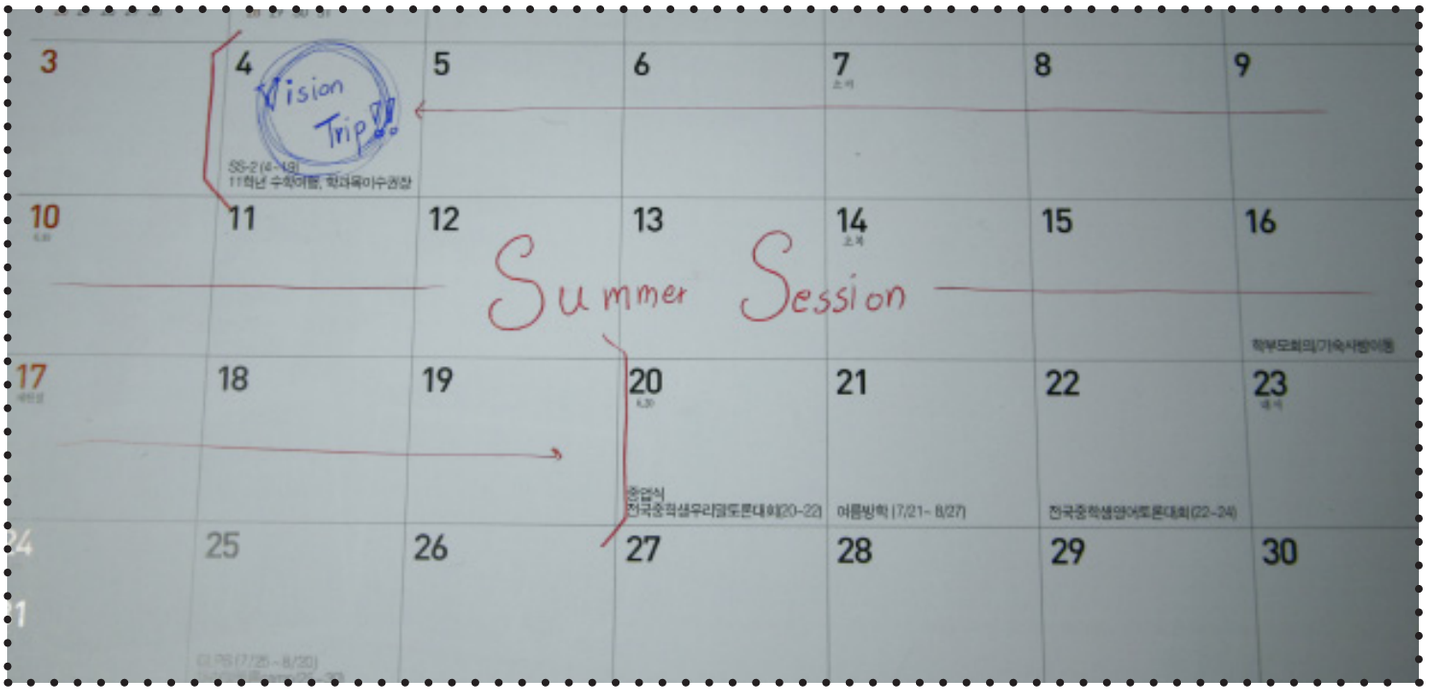
However, this may only apply to the students who were victorious in the 'speed-game'; we need to consider the students who couldn't sign up for programs they wanted simply because they missed the timing. They would have to spend 3 days in regret doing activities they had never thought of. Put aside all the lessons and relationships: will the students even be able to enjoy the period?

There are some problems caused due to giving the students the authority to choose which program to participate in. The types of programs a student chooses would be limited only to the field that the student is interested in. Yes, it's good that the students would enjoy attending the programs that they like, and it is true that we have to respect their own decisions. But we can't ignore the fact that the students will not be provided with the opportunity to try activities of different fields and parts. Students should be trying out many different things in order to seek for their favorites and shape themselves -but this process may never take place.

There were some programs that only took a minute or so until the quota was filled. In contrast, some were cancelled because not enough students had signed up. It may seem somewhat obvious, but in the long term, it is a serious problem. This year, only the programs with relaxing or exciting activities survived. Probably the results are going to be of no difference next year either. However, there are experiences that are necessary in nourishing our bodies and hearts, learning how to overcome hardships, and getting motivated for studying such as cross-country, learning Korean traditional music or volunteering at rehabilitation facilities. If we leave it up to the students to choose which program to take, nobody would be willing to exchange Camping or Water Sports for these programs. Every year, teachers would be more and more reluctant to suggest meaningful programs, and as time passes, the original purpose of learning life and the world outside the classroom will be distorted.

Gazing at the stars, watching movies on the beach, experiencing French cuisine, fishing at the sea and many others: these are what KMLA students are planning for their beginning of summer. Of course, the most important thing is to enjoy that moment and seize the day. However, in order to make much out of this period instead of it being a mere experience, all you need a little bit of consideration and a sense of balance. That way, these three days would become the most precious time of your school life, or maybe even your whole life.

Lee Chung-Hyun (B)
16th wave, junior editorialist



Too Much to Sacrifice

Summer Session was implemented to make good use of time. Since Advanced Placement classes fail to hold the students' attention after the exams in May, Korean Minjok Leadership Academy scheduled Summer Session for almost right after the exams. This year, however, 15th wavers won't have Summer Session. Instead, the students are sent on the Vision Trip. The sad sighs about the school grounds, however, prove that Summer Session is just too important to sacrifice.

Summer Session is the only time of the year when students can concentrate on research. Although Individual Research and classes titled Project Studies are available to students during the year, most students are often too busy to devote their mind and body into research during the regular semesters. Teachers are also often too busy to supervise research because they have many other classes to teach. For example, 15th wavers who wanted to take Project Studies on Economics with Ms. Kim Min-Ju had to have their class moved to the IR period because Ms. Kim couldn't fit the class into her regular schedule. Only during Summer Session can the teachers carefully look over what their students are doing and guide them in their research.

Without Summer Session, students also lose the opportunity to take more advanced classes like Contemporary Physics that are not open during regular semesters. During the spring and fall semesters, students often tend to take classes that can earn them good grades, and prepare them for college entrance exams. However, the biggest reason that students do not take such challenging courses is that students have other more important mandatory classes to study. During Summer Session, students are more likely to take advanced classes because they do not have mandatory classes.

Summer Session is also a romance for the teachers. Teachers are more likely to open courses that are less academic, but still deserving attention, like American Drama Studies. Teachers do not have much freedom to open their dream classes during the regular school year, because they are often too occupied teaching the regular academic courses. Summer Session is needed for teachers and students to acquire both extensive knowledge about such subjects and be free from worries of being behind in academics of those in other schools.

Not only can the students take unique classes during Summer Session, but they can also participate in club activities and pursue other interests more actively. Some students write pieces of literature, some students practice instruments, and some students prepare for competitions. During regular semesters, it's hard to do so due to schoolwork. By participating in club activities more actively, Summer Session can serve as the time to find the students' true interests.

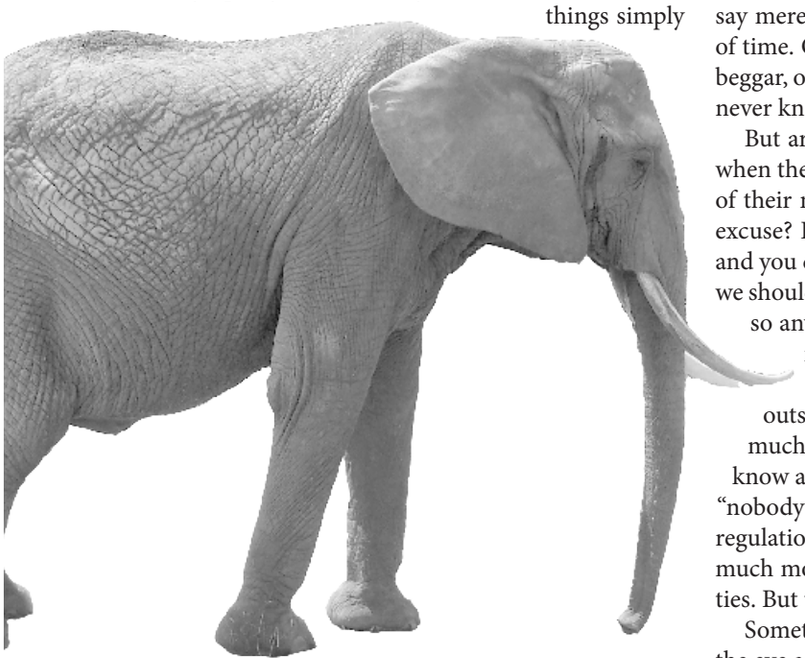
There are numerous other problems caused by the vision trip scheduled during Summer Session. One of them is scheduling a school-wide event. For example, KMLA Academic Festival was supposed to be held after the finals, but it was hard to find a date, because the 15th wavers went on the vision trip from July 4th. Also, course registration for 2nd semester had to be rushed due to 15th wavers being away during Summer Session.

When we stepped into the gate of Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, we had a dream of researching, taking advanced courses unavailable in other schools, and learning about those subjects that interest us, to find our true selves. Unfortunately, being high school students, the reality may seem far from the dream we had before entering KMLA. Although we can't do what we had dreamed of during regular school years our dreams do come true during Summer Session. Yet, the school is trying to get rid of this unique opportunity.

Suna Yoo
Staff Editorialist, 15th waver

The *Secret* That Everybody Knows

If India has the Untouchables, Korea has the beggars in the subways. It is an exaggeration, of course, to state that these unfortunate men and women who populate the underground passages of Korea are so accursed. But the basis of this hyperbole still stands true: most "regular," more well-off people of Korea will never really interact with this different "breed." Of course this does not mean that we will never feel anything towards the different. We sometimes feel pity; we sometimes feel sympathy; and – usually near Christmas, when all things simply



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must be jolly and good – we sometimes feel compassion, and even take the trouble to drop a hundred-*won* coin into the poor man's basket. Yet beggars still are, to the majority of the population, merely a factor of the everyday background of the Korean subways or the city streets. After all, we have so many other things to think about and fiddle with when we pass them by on the subways. This is not a cold-blooded generalization. This is reality, for statement we've all learned in economics class is quite true: people need an incentive to act and an acknowledgement that helping out beggars isn't always at the top of our priorities.

Or, at least this should be the reality. However, we cannot be characterize people based solely on by rigid terms and numbers, for we *do* have, obviously, humanitarian characteristics. We pay attention to these "unimportant" issues more than we think. Look at not only the beggar himself, but at the crowds of people passing him by: they avoid looking at the man directly, but instead avert their eyes if they are guilty of something. Of course, some do not even take care to notice. But when the poor man's lonely harmonica tune catches their unwilling ear, people turn their heads, suddenly become busy with some trivial task. When his sunken eyes emptily gaze before him, people's footsteps are hastened by an unseen force. They are mortified. It's not because of his tattered clothes or his ungainly appearance. People – in essence, our selves – are uneasy, because they *know* someone who needs help is there and yet they are passing him by. It's the uncomfortable truth. It's the white elephant in the room. It's the secret that everybody knows but will always avoid.

Yet people pass the beggar by with discomfort, for it's an unwritten rule not to go out of your way to help a man whom you will probably never see again. There are those who break this rule, of course. But most give excuses for their behavior: nobody else is doing it. To break the routine behavior of society would be wrong and embarrassing, even if theoretically it is the right thing to do. Some say merely dropping a coin doesn't help at all, and thus it's a waste of time. Others go back to the basics and ask: is that beggar really a beggar, or a well-off man in disguise for extra pocket money? We can never know, they say, and so we are justified in our aloof inaction.

But are we really justified? Are all those people truly reasonable when they know they have something tugging at them in the corner of their minds? Or are we merely taking inaction as a comfortable excuse? Beggars may be a small start, but look at the bigger things and you can notice that humans are indeed repetitive. We know that we shouldn't dump trash in a big heap instead of recycling, but we do so anyway. We know that we shouldn't let a friend be entrapped in a witch hunt, but we can only stay silent. We know that we should care about an issue – whether it's inside school or outside in the world – but we have too many quizzes to take, too much homework to do, and too many things to care about. We know a lot of things, and yet we don't always act on them, because "nobody else does." After all, everything – economic crises, school regulation problems, and the extinction of mankind – might seem much more distant than your U.S. History quiz or your club activities. But the problems start from such a perspective.

Sometimes we need to look at that beggar man in the subway in the eye and pay him some attention, to give him some kind word or maybe even a coin to help him from his troubles. There is no guarantee that this will help him. But the true solutions do start from attention and recognition, whether the problems lie in personal matters of relationships or worldly issues of the environment and economies. There is a reason for the expression "face the problem," after all, for you need to confront your problem before you can truly solve it. Acknowledge the beggar man before he dies of despair. Capture the white elephant before it tramples over your world. And if anybody tells you a secret that everybody knows, shout it out to the world, so that it is not a secret anymore, but a reality and a wish.

Jiyeon Koh
Staff Editorialist, 15th Wave

http://news.change.org/stories/should-we-embrace-power-law-policies

Evaluation of the Non-graded System

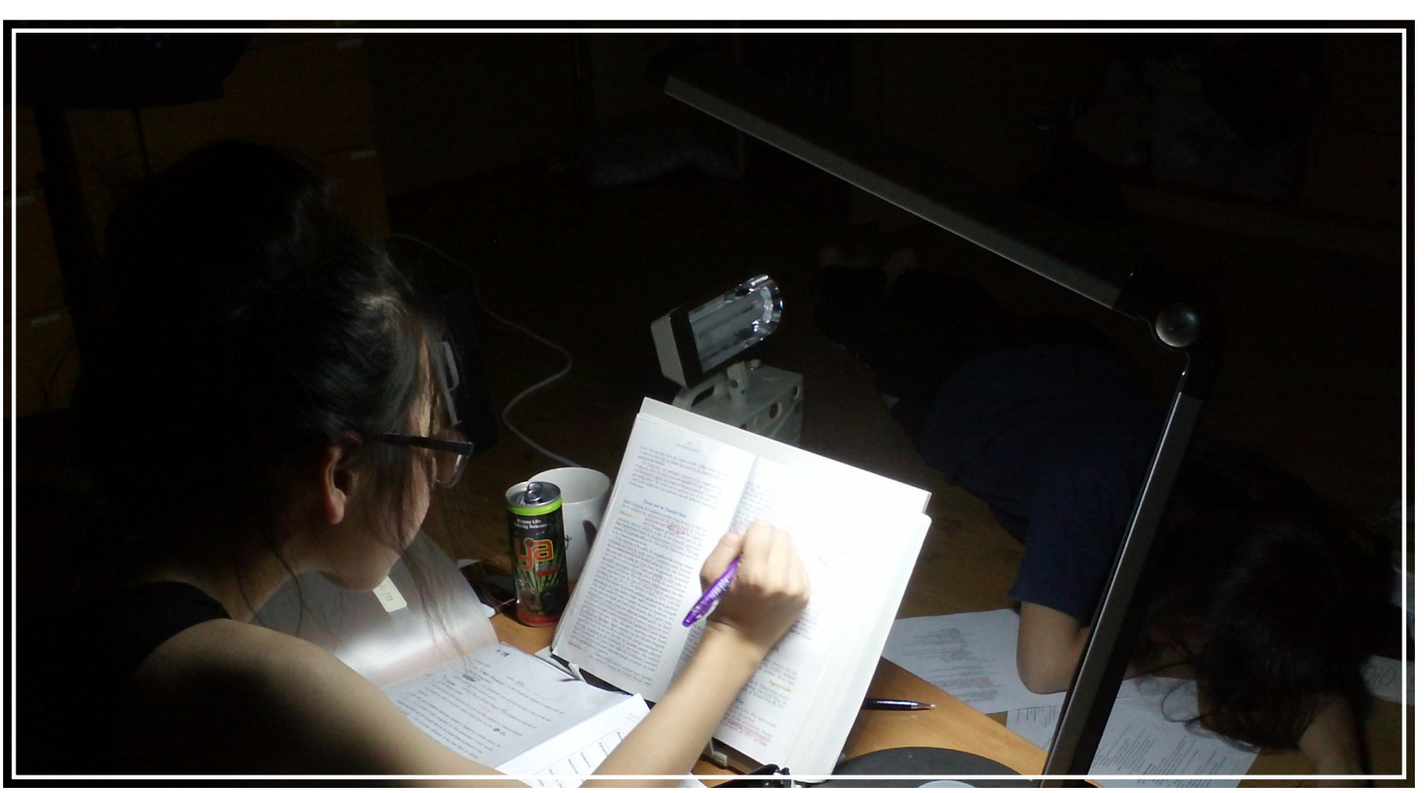
One feather in Korean Minjok Leadership Academy's cap is the course registration system, a system in which students are given the liberty to choose the courses in the sciences, social studies, the arts, and talent and aptitude. Until this semester, all courses were open to a specific wave of students, so even if students were free to sign up for classes of their liking, they could only take classes with their peers. In classes, they were not able to cooperate or participate with other wavers, who were taught in classes of their own. However, this semester, the school decided to take the course registration system a step further and introduced a non-graded system in which students could take any course regardless of waves. According to my observations, however, this new system has proven to be ineffective so far and will probably stay that way no matter how long it continues.

The ineffectiveness of this system is most visible in the lack of significant changes – changes that its application was expected to bring about. In enacting this policy, the school's goal was to break down the barriers set by grades in taking courses, and yet, during most classes, different wavers are required to play 21st century Pyramus and Thisbe, communicating over walls. Teachers at the start of the semester announced to the students that the 16th wavers should register a course in this module while the 15th wavers should register the same course in another. Not only teachers, but students also discussed the new system in social networks and conducted votes to decide in which modules the 16th wavers should register courses. Thanks to the efforts of the teachers and the teached alike, there are either classes consisting of only one wave or those with small islands of one wave in a sea of another. Even in the latter cases, grading and ranking of the 15th and 16th waves are done separately, causing a bigger workload for the teachers. In short, nothing has improved, only confusion and complexities have been generated, and it has only gone from bad to worse.

What's even more serious, the problems inherent in this system imply that the current situation will not improve. The gap between older and younger waves is the main problem. This poses questions about fairness of the grading system. The older wavers have learned a year's worth more than the younger wavers, inevitably causing the sunbaes to have an advantage over the hoobaes due to their additional knowledge and experiences. If, as a solution, the grading system is run separately, as is now, there is absolutely no point in taking classes together. This system is one usually practiced in colleges or universities where a long history of its reinforcements have led to developments of policies and orders that make it applicable. Considering the time, energy, and efforts that would go into changing KMLA that way, it would rather be more beneficial to revert back to the original system and leave it as it is.

Yes, to the eyes of the general Korean public, this new non-graded system makes KMLA stand out and seem more advanced compared to other typical high schools of this nation. However, let us be logical. Let us think from the perspective of the people inside KMLA. Let us think from the perspective of those directly affected by the system. Let us think from the perspective that actually matters. Let us realize that the new system is merely a false display and show of the uniqueness of KMLA, and revert to the older one.

Eun Ji Lee
Junior Writer, 16th Waver



EDITORIAL

page 33
BACK TO THE OLD

Midterms and Finals

You walk into the elevator and press the eleventh floor button. You get out just to notice that most of the seats are occupied and that the spaces are too cramped. Then you sigh, and think back upon the times when it was not the exam period, wishing that you were back in that situation. The usually empty seats are occupied and those who were not seen on the eleventh floor are seen. You finally sit and study, only to continue on your stress filled, miserable day. This is what is normally like on a day during the exam periods.

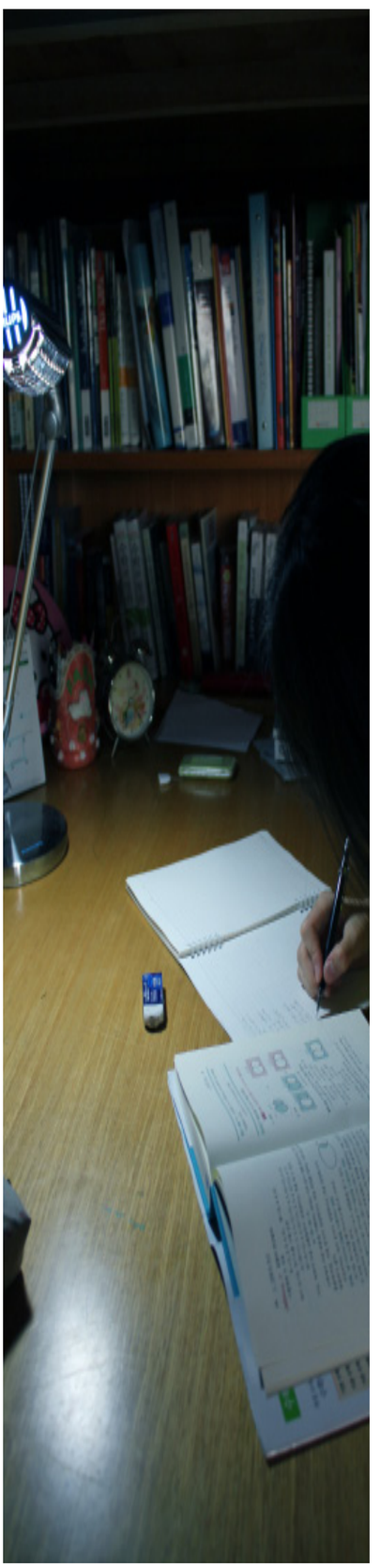
Exam period has always been a huge fuss to students due to its pressure in their grades. In most of the classes both the mid-term and the finals are each worth 30% of the final grade, making the combined total of it 60%, while the rest of the 40% is about class performance. The class performance grades are divided into different parts such as homework, attitude, presentations, and etc. However, for a majority of the classes here at Korean Minjok Leadership Academy, 40% of class performance is a grade that rarely holds any importance and is an easy score. As a result, students at KMLA are safe to assume that as long as they get satisfying scores on their midterm and finals, their As would be assured, which is indeed true for most of the subjects. Moreover, if students are rest assured about their grades, they do not have any motive or incentive to participate daily during class.

Walk into any class and I guarantee you that you will find at least two or three students sleeping. Especially in classes where the daily participation has no importance to the grade of the class, I would further like to guarantee you that half of the class would be asleep. Of course there are teachers who care and do not care whether the student is asleep in class. But, even if the teacher does not care, students should take the mindset that they should not fall asleep but rather should participate more during class. Students should be fully aware of the consequences of falling asleep; thus, I would like to ask those students who do fall asleep often in class whether they really know the consequences of sleeping, and what they are getting themselves into by sleeping. Furthermore, by posing this question, I am as well asking how not participating in class would result in as well.

Personally, I do not regard myself as a good test-taker; however, I do consider myself as an ardent participator in class. In fact, I am a horrible test-taker, but my test scores do not reflect who I am during class. And I do believe that the same applies for everyone else; many students' score may not represent who they really are to the teacher. Despite this, the results of class can be separated into two different outcomes, the tangible and the intangible. The tangible outcomes would be the actual score of the final grade, and the intangible outcome would be a bond between the teacher and the students.

My only complaint is that students mainly look at the tangible outcomes of their scores, which I primarily blame on the midterm and final exams. I want to stress the importance of participation because test scores do not prove much. Yes, they prove that you are a good test taker, study hard, and are smart; however, what teachers only see in good test scores is the students behind the books, not in class. Participation in class proves that the student enjoys the subject, and is studying for the sake of studying rather than for the sake of scores. The student behind the books would give a bad impression that they only study for the sake of scores. Regardless if the teacher cares about a student sleeping or not, he or she will make judgments about the student anyhow. Thus, if we reduce the amount of percentage of the midterm and final exams, the students will be more assertive in class about participating, because they know that their class performances may and can be more important than their exams. In classes such as those of Mr. Wayne or Mr. Ganse's classes where there are no exams, or those of Mr. Johnson or Mr. Park Kwan-Su's where the exam percentages are lowered, students have the incentive to participate in class, focus more on presentations and term papers- rather than sticking their noses in books all the time.

KMLA is a place for opportunity; one of the greatest opportunities being the chance to collaborate and interact with other teachers and students. It is a special place for everyone where they get an opportunity to grow and to show off their growth. Not only that, but it is also an academy for future scholars who should be discussing several ideas together and collaborating both in and out of classes. If you start, not only chatting with your friends, but enthusiastically participating in class with the rest of your classmates and teacher, it will become one of the greatest opportunities for you to show who you really are, express your ideas, share yours and others ideas, and find room for development.



Back to the Old

When I look back on my freshman life in KMLA, one of the things that pulled me through the stressful and dreary days was the fact that in the upcoming year, I would be able to eat my meals as soon as I came back from school. It probably sounds silly to anyone outside of KMLA to understand (and even to some KMLAians), but the fact is that mealtimes matter to many. However, things being as they stand, I can say with certainty that the mealtimes in KMLA are like the morning rush hours in Times Square, and that up until last year, it had been the happy privilege of the seniors and juniors to eat first. Unfortunately, this semester saw the implementation of a new school policy that declared the rotation of the privilege around to each grade, with the justification that the elder students were hogging all the good food.

There is some truth in that claim, and I'll admit that when it comes to good food, the majority of the students rush in for extra servings when the cafeteria ladies look away. However, that's something that can be fixed with just a little bit more effort from the cafeteria staff, or possibly through the more mandatory efforts of the students themselves. Instead, the school administration decided in an one-way fashion to create more problems in the process of solving one.

From the student's perspective, one of the worst things about eating late is that it is really hard to get things done with the same efficiency in the ten minutes or so coming before and after the meal, as it is to get done during an incessant twenty minutes. Of course, the same amount of time is allotted to the student no matter what time they eat, but the amount of concentration, and ultimately the amount of work the students can pull off in twenty continuous minutes is very different from that of twenty minutes with a distracting lunch period in the middle. Not only that, but for students who wish to sleep during meal breaks, this system proves a dilemma. In the end, most students choose not to cut short their nap to a mere ten minutes, and simply decide to skip their meal.

Some people may ask, 'is it fair then to have the freshmen eat late throughout the whole year?' To this I believe, the majority of the KMLA student body (yes, even the freshmen!), will reply 'Absolutely,' for although at first glance it seems like an unfair policy to the freshmen, it will eventually serve as a boon to them as well. After all, if the system lasts, the freshmen will get their fair chance to enjoy the privilege of eating first in the upcoming years, when they will be busier and more eager than they are at present to make efficient use of their time. We also cannot completely disregard the sunbae-hoobae relationships that undoubtedly exists within our school, which is one of the defining cultures of our student population.

As to the initial problem of the impartial distribution of good food resulting from the old system, why, how hard will that be to solve? Before, the system was rather inefficient in the fact that proper restrictions were not placed on the students to prevent them from taking more than their share. However, that can be easily fixed with an assortment of methods. For one, the cafeteria ladies themselves could distribute the food that seems susceptible of being devoured without reserve by greedy mouths. Or perhaps as an alternative, we could have a couple of students distribute the food with the incentive of reward points. If that doesn't assure the teachers, we could even throw in a few penalty points in case the students neglect their responsibility, just to make the system sound. There are numerous solutions to fix the problem.

This being said, I believe that the thing to do is for the whole student body to raise their voices together in protest of the current lunch system. Especially for the freshmen, who will be able to eat first daily in just a few months if the old system revives, I urge to take action. It would be beneficial to the student body as a whole, and the results will be a guaranteed happier, less confused, and a more efficient school lunch system.

COLLEGE COLUMN

FINDING THE RIGHT COLLEGE

CC, PG34

Rivalry Between the Best

Two best institutes of technology located on two opposite sides of the United States–students and faculty of each institute argue that they are the best-"est." Both colleges show off the best research facilities, compacted talent of faculty and staff, exceptionally intelligent students, not to forget the beauty of school campus and the feverish school spirit. Friend and rival are two words as unfitting as words can come to describe a single thing. However "friendly rivalry" would be a perfect way to sum up their relationship. Not many of you know more than the fact that these colleges are renowned for its highly selective student body and they are the best choices you have if you were to go for engineering. Here, *Minjok Herald* presents you with the differences that make both MIT, Massachusetts Institute of Technology, and Caltech, California Institute of Technology, the best, moreover the best-"est."

MIT is located in Cambridge, Massachusetts while–as I somewhat mentioned above–Caltech is located in Pasadena, California. Both colleges are found in urban areas, although the campus of MIT is 168 acres, about 40 acres larger than Caltech's. Last year MIT enrolled 4232 undergraduates and 6152 graduate students and the college employs about 1,000 faculty members. Number-wise, Caltech is much smaller, seeing that they enrolled 900 undergraduates and 1200 graduate students and employs 300, if counting professorial faculty only. Despite the small size Caltech shows great achievements with 31 alumni and faculty to have won the Nobel Prize and 65 in total to have won the National Medal of Science, while MIT has 76 Nobel Laureates but 50 National Medal of Science. Being smaller, Caltech managed 332 million dollars in sponsored research in 2010, which is half the amount MIT managed that same year.

MIT was established 30 years before Caltech was. In response to the industrial revolution, MIT put focus on applied technology, leading to close relationship and cooperation with industrial businesses. While such historical era triggered the foundation of MIT, 30 years past the industrialization was established Caltech, with the primary motive of providing preparatory and vocational courses. However, the college attracted influential scientists like Robert Andrews Millikan and Arthur Amos Noyes, which led to the present Calthech with its emphasis on science and engineering.

Many of you reading this college column of *Minjok Herald* must be in the International field, perhaps interested in the science and mathematics department–thereby most likely interested in knowing about the entry to these colleges. Both MIT and Caltech are exceedingly selective of their admitting students. Caltech received about 5000 applications for the class of 2014 and only 12 percent were admitted (610) and 222 of them enrolled. MIT received 16000 students and admitted ten percent and 64 percent of those admitted enrolled. The interquartile range, or midspread, on SAT was 2030-2320 and 2200-2330 for those admitted to MIT and Caltech respectively.

At the Admissions Office of Caltech, there are no exact formulas to which the counselors plug in the applications and calculate a yes or no. Caltech admissions counselors assert that they look at each student's background, their home, family, school, community and situations. There are no such things as comparing one student to another. They measure the academics abilities through test scores, grades and recommendations. They take into great consideration the extracurricular activities the student engages in. No interviews are conducted to applicants although encouragements are made to visit the campus and attend in information sessions and campus tours.

MIT requires SAT Reasoning Test or the ACT Plus Writing, two SAT subject Tests one of math and another of science. Interviews are highly recommended by optional. As does Caltech, MIT considers your scores and grades under the consideration of the background and your high school standards.

Now about the tuition, fees, room, board, supplies, and personal expenses. MIT, all the costs sum up to about 45,000 to 50,000 dollars per year, while financial aid award–scholarships, loans and work–is more than 35,000 dollars. About 60 percent of students received need-based financial aid. For Caltech, the total annual costs on students are about 50,000 to 55,000 while average financial aid of most students qualified was about 35,000 dollars. Undergraduates of MIT are guaranteed four-year housing in one of its twelve dorms. About 95 percent of Caltech first year undergraduates live on campus house systems.

School spirits are things much highlighted in both schools. As most of you have seen at least once on college t-shirts, MIT, being the school established during the industrialization, its representative colors are cardinal red and steel gray. Caltech's colors are orange and white. Both colleges' mascots are beavers, the "nature's engineer." Students of Caltech and MIT participate in tens of intercollegiate sports in the NCAA Division III, under the name of Beavers and Engineers, respectively.

These two colleges do not show school spirit through typical fight songs and dancing mascots. Each houses of Caltech perform different customs, for example the Flems fire off their cannon after graduation, while during Halloween seasons the Dabney House perform a "pumpkin drop" from the highest point on campus. MIT underlines its playful, imaginative and inventive spirit through staging pranks, otherwise called "hacks," always following their own loosely stated code of ethics.

Many of you may have heard of some pranks that these two highly renowned rivalry schools exchange with each other. To elaborate more on the previously stated "summary" of the relationship between MIT and Caltech, the "friendly rivalry," here are some examples of hacks that were executed over the last few years. In 2005, a group of Caltech people made a trip to MIT and handed out t-shirts wrapped around with plastic written "MIT" on the front, which, when opened, revealed "…because not everyone can go to Caltech" on the back. In revenge and payback for this hack played on MIT students by Caltech, a group of MIT students "borrowed" Caltech students the Flems' 130-year-old cannon and took it across the United States to their campus.

Hard, selective, far, expensive, and best. These words describe both Caltech and MIT. But after reading this article, *Minjok Herald* hopes that those of you who choose engineering take more interest in these colleges and perhaps never give up because hopes and possibilities are thriving in your times.

Lee Ha-jeong
Staff Writer, 15th Wave

Caltech VS MIT

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Number of Undergraduates enrolled	
900	4232
Number of Nobel Laureates	
31	76
Year Established	
1891	1916
Tuition	
50000 ~ 55000	45000 ~ 50000
% Admitted	
12%	10%
SAT Range	
2200 ~ 2330	2030 ~ 2320

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